



SEC PREVIEW

PREDICTED ORDER OF FINISH

	1	GEORGIA BULLDOGS
	2	TEXAS LONGHORNS
	3	OKLAHOMA SOONERS
	4	TEXAS A&M AGGIES
	5	LSU TIGERS
	6	OLE MISS REBELS
	7	ALABAMA CRIMSON TIDE
	8	TENNESSEE VOLUNTEERS
	9	FLORIDA GATORS
	10	SOUTH CAROLINA GAMECOCKS
	11	MISSOURI TIGERS
	12	AUBURN TIGERS
	13	MISSISSIPPI STATE BULLDOGS
	14	VANDERBILT COMMODORES
	15	KENTUCKY WILDCATS
	16	ARKANSAS RAZORBACKS

SEC CHAMPIONSHIP

GEORGIA OVER TEXAS



JOIN COLLEGE FOOTBALL EXPERT STEVEN LASSAN AT ATHLONSPORTS.COM FOR A LOOK AT SECOND- AND THIRD-TEAM SELECTIONS

ALL-SEC TEAM

FIRST-TEAM OFFENSE

QB	ARCH MANNING	Texas
RB	AHMAD HARDY	Missouri
RB	KEWAN LACY	Ole Miss
AP	JADAN BAUGH	Florida
WR	CAM COLEMAN	Texas
WR	RYAN COLEMAN-WILLIAMS	Alabama
WR	MARIO CRAVER	Texas A&M
TE	TREY'DEZ GREEN	LSU
C	DREW BOBO	Georgia
OL	TREVOR GOOSBY	Texas
OL	CAYDEN GREEN	Missouri
OL	EARNEST GREENE III	Georgia
OL	JORDAN SEATON	LSU

FIRST-TEAM DEFENSE

DL	COLIN SIMMONS	Texas
DL	DYLAN STEWART	South Carolina
DL	DAVID STONE	Oklahoma
DL	TAYLOR WEIN	Oklahoma
LB	WHIT WEEKS	LSU
LB	XAVIER ATKINS	Auburn
LB	RASHEEM BILES	Texas
LB	RAYLEN WILSON	Georgia
CB	ELLIS ROBINSON IV	Georgia
CB	KELLEY JONES	Mississippi State
S	KJ BOLDEN	Georgia
S	BRAY HUBBARD	Alabama

FIRST-TEAM SPECIALISTS

K	TATE SANDELL	Oklahoma
P	GRAYSON MILLER	Oklahoma
KR	RAYSHAWN PLEASANT	Auburn
PR	RYAN NIBLETT	Texas

BOWL PROJECTIONS

Gator: Alabama vs. SMU

Texas: Missouri vs. Oklahoma State

Birmingham: Vanderbilt vs. Tulane

Music City: South Carolina vs. Nebraska

Reliaquest: Florida vs. Penn State

Citrus: Ole Miss vs. Michigan

Liberty: Auburn vs. Kansas State

Duke's Mayo: Tennessee vs. Virginia

Tech

College Football Playoff First Round:

LSU vs. Miami (Fla.)

College Football Playoff First

Round: Oklahoma vs. Texas A&M

Cotton (CFP Quarterfinals):

Texas vs. Oregon

Peach (CFP Quarterfinals):

Georgia vs. Miami (Fla.)

Rose (CFP Quarterfinals):

Oklahoma vs. Ohio State

Sugar (CFP Semifinals):

Georgia vs. Texas

National Championship:

Georgia vs. Ohio State

COORDINATOR CAROUSEL

ALABAMA

Offense: New: Ryan Grubb; Old: Ryan Grubb, Nick Sheridan, JaMarcus Shephard

ARKANSAS

Offense: New: Tim Cramsey; Old: Bobby Petrino **Defense:** New: Ron Roberts, Deron Wilson; Old: Chris Wilson (interim)

AUBURN

Offense: New: Kodi Burns, Joel Gordon; Old: Derrick Nix **Defense:** New: DJ Durkin, Tim Banks; Old: DJ Durkin

FLORIDA

Offense: New: Buster Faulkner; Old: Russ Callaway **Defense:** New: Brad White; Old: Ron Roberts, Robert Bala, Vinnie Sunseri

KENTUCKY

Offense: New: Joe Sloan; Old: Bush Hamdan **Defense:** New: Jay Bateman; Old: Brad White

LSU

Offense: New: Charlie Weis Jr., Joe Cox; Old: Joe Sloan **Defense:** New: Blake Baker, Chris Kiffin; Old: Blake Baker

MISSISSIPPI STATE

Defense: New: Zach Arnett, Matt Brock; Old: Coleman Hutzler

MISSOURI

Offense: New: Chip Lindsey; Old: Kirby Moore **Defense:** New: Corey Batoon, Derek Nicholson; Old: Corey Batoon

OLE MISS

Offense: New: John David Baker, Cody Woodiel; Old: Charlie Weis Jr. **Defense:** New: Bryan Brown, Marcus Woodson; Old: Pete Golding

SOUTH CAROLINA

Offense: New: Kendal Briles; Old: Mike Furrey (interim) **Defense:** New: Clayton White, Torrian Gray; Old: Clayton White

TENNESSEE

Defense: New: Jim Knowles, Anthony Poindexter; Old: Tim Banks

TEXAS

Defense: New: Will Muschamp, Johnny Nansen; Old: Pete Kwiatkowski

TEXAS A&M

Offense: New: Holmon Wiggins; Old: Collin Klein **Defense:** New: Lyle Hemphill, Elijah Robinson; Old: Jay Bateman

TOP 10 RECRUITS

NAME	POS.	SCHOOL	RATING	NAT. RANK
1. Jared Curtis	QB	Vanderbilt	★★★★★	2
2. Ekene Ogboko	OT	Georgia	★★★★	9
3. Lamar Brown	DL	LSU	★★★★★	10
4. Julian Walker	EDGE	South Carolina	★★★★	15
5. Richard Anderson	DL	LSU	★★★★	18



ELLIS ROBINSON IV, GEORGIA
CAM COLEMAN, TEXAS



TOP TRANSFERS

NAME	POS.	SCHOOL	FORMER SCHOOL
1. Cam Coleman	WR	Texas	Auburn
The most coveted pass-catcher in the portal will be Arch Manning's top target.			
2. Jordan Seaton	OL	LSU	Colorado
Seaton is a rare talent who toughens up the Tigers in the trenches.			
3. Sam Leavitt	QB	LSU	Arizona State
Leavitt is an ideal fit for head coach Lane Kiffin's high-powered offense.			
4. Byrum Brown	QB	Auburn	South Florida
Brown is a player who led the nation in total offense and total touchdowns in 2025.			
5. Princewill Umanmielen	Edge	LSU	Ole Miss
Umanmielen's nine sacks put him among the country's top returning pass-rushers.			
6. Jacarrius Peak	OL	South Carolina	NC State
Peak shores up a line that struggled to protect the quarterback and open rushing lanes.			
7. Austin Simmons	QB	Missouri	Ole Miss
Still just 20 years old, Simmons gets a second chance at a starting job in the SEC.			
8. Kenny Minchey Jr.	QB	Kentucky	Notre Dame
Minchey finally gets the opportunity to start for head coach Will Stein's first UK team.			
9. Hollywood Smothers	RB	Texas	NC State
Smothers brings rare receiving chops and big-play ability to a rebuilt RB room.			
10. Rasheem Biles	LB	Texas	Pitt
Biles stuffed the stat sheet in the ACC; he'll be the heart of the Longhorns' defense.			

RECRUITING RANKINGS BY SCHOOL

1. Alabama (3)	6. LSU (12)	11. Vanderbilt (25)
2. Georgia (5)	7. Oklahoma (13)	12. Mississippi State (26)
3. Texas (8)	8. Florida (15)	13. Missouri (34)
4. Texas A&M (9)	9. South Carolina (17)	14. Auburn (43)
5. Tennessee (10)	10. Ole Miss (24)	15. Kentucky (54)
		16. Arkansas (59)

Rankings per Rivals; National ranking in parentheses

GAMES TO WATCH

Sept. 12 Ohio State at Texas	Oct. 10 Texas vs. Oklahoma (Dallas)
Sept. 12 Oklahoma at Michigan	Nov. 7 Georgia at Ole Miss
Sept. 19 LSU at Ole Miss	Nov. 7 Alabama at LSU
Sept. 26 Texas A&M at LSU	Nov. 14 Texas at LSU
Sept. 26 Oklahoma at Georgia	Nov. 27 Texas at Texas A&M
Oct. 10 Georgia at Alabama	Nov. 28 Auburn at Alabama

NAME	POS.	SCHOOL	RATING	NAT. RANK
6. EJ Crowell	RB	Alabama	★★★★★	19
7. Brandon Arrington	CB	Texas A&M	★★★★★	20
8. Jett Thomalla	QB	Alabama	★★★★	24
9. Corey Barber Jr.	WR	LSU	★★★★	28
10. Richard Wesley	EDGE	Texas	★★★★	29

Rankings per Rivals; +Consensus 5-star prospect



ALABAMA CRIMSON TIDE

NATIONAL FORECAST: 15 | SEC PREDICTION: 7 | 2025 RECORD: 11-4, 7-1 SEC

OFFENSE Remember when Ryan Williams was a 17-year-old phenom early in the 2024 season? Now he's a junior and Alabama's most experienced returning offensive player — and he's looking for a fresh start. He's now Ryan Coleman-Williams and wears a new jersey number (1) after a rocky sophomore season marred by one of the nation's highest drop rates.

He'll have a different quarterback throwing him passes this season, with fourth-year Austin Mack and second-year Keelon Russell in a competition to replace Ty Simpson. But it's Alabama's offensive line and running game where the focus lies after the Crimson Tide averaged 3.4 yards per carry in 2025, their third-worst mark since 1970. The offensive line, which lost Kadyn Proctor and Parker Brailsford to the NFL draft, is leaning on 2025 5-star recruit Michael Carroll to anchor a group that dipped heavily into the portal this offseason for help.

Alabama is also sorting through several options in its backfield, which is led by bruising Daniel Hill and added 5-star freshman EJ Crowell.

DEFENSE If you're doing some early scouting for the 2027 NFL Draft, Alabama's defense features at least two players who could be first-round picks next year — outside linebacker Yhonzae Pierre and cornerback Zabien Brown. The decision by Pierre to return for his fourth season bolsters a front that suffered significant losses to the draft or transfer portal.

The Tide's defense was overpowered in a Rose Bowl loss to Indiana, prompting a search for bigger bodies. Oregon's Terrance Green (6-foot-5, 319) and USC's Devan Thompkins (6-foot-5, 298) are the headliners of the portal class, and Alabama needs an impact from Virginia Tech transfer Caleb Woodson at an otherwise inexperienced inside linebacker spot.

In contrast, the secondary remains almost intact, with plenty of experience at safety in Bray Hubbard (fourth year) and Keon Sabb (fifth year).

SPECIALISTS Special teams struggles proved costly last season, including some key missed kicks by Conor Talty. Talty decided to remain at Alabama for a fourth season but is facing competition from Marshall transfer Lorcan Quinn. The Tide will have a new punter — either second-year Alex Asparuhov or FCS North Alabama transfer Adam Watford.

FINAL ANALYSIS Head coach Kalen DeBoer believes that his team took a step forward in his second season, appearing in the SEC Championship Game and winning a College Football Playoff game for the first time since the 2021 season. But a season bookended by embarrassing losses to Florida State in the opener and then to Georgia and Indiana left a sour taste in the mouths of Tide fans, who are expecting better results in Year 3.

2025 RESULTS (11-4, 7-1 SEC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 30	at Florida State	L	17-31	Sept. 5	East Carolina	1. EJ Crowell, RB	★★★★★
Sept. 6	ULM	W	73-0	Sept. 12	at Kentucky	2. Jett Thomalla, QB	★★★★★
Sept. 13	Wisconsin	W	38-14	Sept. 19	Florida State	3. Xavier Griffin, LB	★★★★
Sept. 27	at Georgia	W	24-21	Sept. 26	South Carolina	4. Jordan Edmonds, CB	★★★★
Oct. 4	Vanderbilt	W	30-14	Oct. 3	at Mississippi State	5. Jared Doughty, OT	★★★★
Oct. 11	at Missouri	W	27-24	Oct. 10	Georgia	6. Jamarion Matthews, EDGE	★★★★
Oct. 18	Tennessee	W	37-20	Oct. 17	at Tennessee	7. Cederian Morgan, WR	★★★★
Oct. 25	at South Carolina	W	29-22	Oct. 24	Texas A&M	8. Jireh Edwards, S	★★★★
Nov. 8	LSU	W	20-9	Nov. 7	at LSU	9. Chris Booker, IOL	★★★★
Nov. 15	Oklahoma	L	21-23	Nov. 14	at Vanderbilt	10. Nolan Wilson, DL	★★★★
Nov. 22	Eastern Illinois	W	56-0	Nov. 21	Chattanooga		
Nov. 29	at Auburn	W	27-20	Nov. 28	Auburn		
Dec. 6	vs. Georgia #	L	7-28				
Dec. 19	at Oklahoma %	W	34-24				
Jan. 1	vs. Indiana &	L	3-38				
#Atlanta %CFB Playoff First Round & Rose Bowl: CFB Playoff Quarterfinal							



KJ JACKSON

SCOUTING THE RAZORBACKS

"They're not considered a sleeping giant. Ryan Silverfield is a great coach who might have taken the wrong Power 4 job at the wrong time. If you look at their SEC schedule, the nine teams that they have to play are pretty daunting, and then you add Utah. That doesn't set up for Year 1 success. In this day and age, if you don't have Year 1 success, narratives get forced upon you that you've gotta find a way to shake. ... [Silverfield] has always had excellent offenses. They put a lot on their quarterback to make checks and reads. He's very calm on game day, and very, very bright. He understands the ending of games and how to handle those situations with timeouts."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (4)

WR	3	CJ BROWN (JR.)	8	Donovan Faupel* (Sr.)
WR	4	Ismael Cisse (Jr.)	9	Jamari Hawkins* (Sr.)
WR	6	Chris Marshall* (Sr.)	1	Courtney Crutchfield (So.)
LT	75	Kavion Broussard* (So.)	74	Terence Roberson Jr.* (So.)
LG	71	Malachi Breland* (Jr.)	51	Davion Weatherspoon* (Sr.)
C	52	CADEN KITLER (SR.)	53	Kash Courtney (Fr.)
RG	50	KOBE BRANHAM (SO.)	73	Brooks Edmonson (Sr.)
RT	64	Bryant Williams* (Sr.)	54	Adam Hawkes* (So.)
TE	83	JADEN PLATT (JR.)	85	Ty Lockwood* (Jr.)
QB	7	KJ Jackson (So.)	2	AJ Hill* (Fr.)
RB	0	Braylen Russell (Jr.)	5	Sutton Smith* (Sr.)

DEFENSE (2)

DE	97	QUINCY RHODES JR. (SR.)	88	Xadavien Sims* (So.)
NT	92	David Oke (Sr.)	28	Trajen Odom* (Fr.)
DT	0	Hunter Osborne* (Jr.)	91	Carlton Jones* (So.)
JACK	9	Charlie Collins (Jr.)	35	Steven Soles Jr.* (Jr.)
MLB	7	BRADLEY SHAW (JR.)	42	Jeremy Evans* (Sr.)
WLB	25	Ja'Quavion Smith* (Jr.)	10	Wyatt Simmons (So.)
CB	20	Jahiem Johnson* (Jr.)	2	Shelton Lewis* (Jr.)
CB	4	La'Khi Roland* (Jr.)	17	DJ Hairston Jr.* (So.)
STAR	6	Khmeri House* (Jr.)	13	Carter Stoutmire* (Sr.)
S	24	Miguel Mitchell (Sr.)	14	Kyeaure Magloire* (Sr.)
S	1	Christian Harrison* (Sr.)	22	Tay Lockett (Fr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	30	Max Gilbert* (Jr.)	KR	5	Sutton Smith* (Sr.)
P	37	Gavin Rush (Fr.)	PR	5	Sutton Smith* (Sr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



ARKANSAS RAZORBACKS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 51 | SEC PREDICTION: 16 | 2025 RECORD: 2-10, 0-8 SEC

OFFENSE Can either of the two quarterbacks — returnee KJ Jackson or Memphis transfer AJ Hill — help return the Arkansas Razorbacks respectability in the rugged SEC? First-year head coach Ryan Silverfield is banking on the pair, who have scant major-college experience. Jackson looked more effective in decision-making, mechanics and with the schemes during spring drills, although Hill has more background in the system imported by Silverfield and offensive coordinator Tim Cramsey.

Returning thumper Braylen Russell will compete with Memphis transfer Sutton Smith for reps at tailback. CJ Brown, Ismael Cisse, Jamari Hawkins and the talented but well-traveled Chris Marshall will lead the receiving corps, and Jaden Platt returns at tight end.

Center Caden Kitler and guard Kobe Branham are back on the interior of the offensive front, and the Hogs added large transfers in tackles Kavion Broussard (Ohio) and Bryant Williams (Louisiana) and guard Malachi Breland (Memphis) to form a potential starting five.

DEFENSE End Quincy Rhodes Jr. had a breakout year in 2025, while linebacker Bradley Shaw and safety Miguel Mitchell have logged significant time. Otherwise, there are plenty of newcomers for defensive coordinator Ron Roberts in his base three-down scheme.

The Razorbacks expect big things from Virginia transfer tackle Hunter Osborne and nose David Oke, while transfers Xadavien Sims (Oregon), Carlton Jones (USC) and Trajen Odom (Ohio State) and elite freshmen Danny Beale III and Anthony Kennedy Jr. will help populate the front. The hybrid "Jack" role should be shared among Charlie Collins and others.

Shaw, a solid contributor last season, and Buffalo transfer Ja'Quavion Smith have taken the most linebacker reps with the first unit.

Khmeri House has flashed the potential for a major impact at "Star." Finding depth at cornerback and safety was a priority for the new staff. Transfers Jahiem Johnson, La'Khi Roland, Shelton Lewis, DJ Hairston Jr. and Braydon Lee are in position for the most time at cornerback. At safety, Mitchell has received frequent reps with Carter Stoutmire (Colorado transfer), Christian Harrison (Cincinnati transfer) and others.

SPECIALISTS The Razorbacks have no returning players in the kicking game, but placekicker Max Gilbert, punter Gavin Rush and return specialist Sutton Smith give the coaching staff a potentially solid core.

FINAL ANALYSIS The Razorbacks have a ton of ground to make up, and Silverfield thinks a drastic improvement in turnover margin and a stronger measure of team cohesion will help. A six-win season in Silverfield's debut, given the schedule, would display significant improvement.

2025 RESULTS (2-10, 0-8 SEC)

Aug. 30	Alabama A&M	W	52-7
Sept. 6	vs. Arkansas State #	W	56-14
Sept. 13	at Ole Miss	L	35-41
Sept. 20	at Memphis	L	31-32
Sept. 27	Notre Dame	L	13-56
Oct. 11	at Tennessee	L	31-34
Oct. 18	Texas A&M	L	42-45
Oct. 25	Auburn	L	24-33
Nov. 1	Mississippi State	L	35-38
Nov. 15	at LSU	L	22-23
Nov. 22	at Texas	L	37-52
Nov. 29	Missouri	L	17-31

#Little Rock, AR

2026 SCHEDULE

Sept. 5	North Alabama
Sept. 12	at Utah
Sept. 19	Georgia
Sept. 26	Tulsa
Oct. 3	at Texas A&M
Oct. 10	Tennessee
Oct. 17	at Vanderbilt
Oct. 31	Missouri
Nov. 7	at Auburn
Nov. 14	South Carolina
Nov. 21	at Texas
Nov. 28	LSU

TOP 10 RECRUITS*

1. Hank Hendrix, QB	★★★★
2. TJ Hodges, RB	★★★
3. Jakore Smith, LB	★★★
4. Danny Beale III, DL	★★★
5. Anthony Kennedy Jr., DL	★★★
6. Dequane Prevo, WR	★★★
7. Colton Yarbrough, EDGE	★★★
8. Jalon Copeland, CB	★★★
9. Kyndrick Williams, S	★★★
10. Brandon Ford, CB	★★★

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Ryan Silverfield • Record at School: First Season • Career Record: 50-25 (6+ years) • Offensive Coordinator: Tim Cramsey
Defensive Coordinators: Ron Roberts, Deron Wilson • Location: Fayetteville, Ark. • Stadium: Donald W. Reynolds Razorback Stadium (76,212)



AUBURN TIGERS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 34 | SEC PREDICTION: 12 | 2025 RECORD: 5-7, 1-7 SEC

OFFENSE Auburn hired head coach Alex Golesh from South Florida to spark an offense that never got on track under former head coach Hugh Freeze and hasn't finished in the top 50 in scoring nationally since 2019. Golesh brought in key staff members and offensive performers from USF, including quarterback Byrum Brown, center Cole Best and wide receivers Chas Nimrod, Keshaun Singleton and Jeremiah Koger.

Brown became an elite dual threat under Golesh, eclipsing 3,000 passing yards and 800 rushing yards in 2023 and '25 (he missed half the 2024 season with a lower-leg injury). Now he must deliver in the SEC.

Wide receiver projects well with the USF imports, as Nimrod and others stood out in the spring. Auburn also has ball-carrying options with leading rusher Jeremiah Cobb returning and talented Baylor transfer Bryson Washington arriving. Transfers Jake Johnson (North Carolina) and Jonathan Echols (South Florida) will compete at tight end.

Best, an all-league performer last year, anchors a transfer-heavy offensive line that also includes James Madison tackle Jo Simmons.

DEFENSE Golesh retained defensive coordinator DJ Durkin, a candidate for the head-coaching role after serving as interim, to stabilize a defense that showed promise but remains young in spots. Durkin has a centerpiece in linebacker Xavier Atkins, a first-team All-SEC selection with nine sacks, 17 tackles for a loss and two forced fumbles in 2025.

Elijah Melendez will complement Atkins, and Auburn has depth at safety with returners Eric Winters, Sylvester Smith and AnQuon Fegans. Cornerback is more of an unknown, although UCLA transfer Andre Jordan Jr. should help. "He's been really impressive," Golesh says of Jordan.

The defensive front is transfer-heavy with Cody Sigler (Arkansas State), Da'Shawn Womack (Ole Miss), Nate Johnson (Missouri), Saint Farrior (Appalachian State) and Walter Mathis Jr. (LSU) joining sophomores Jourdin Crawford, Jared Smith and Darrion Smith.

SPECIALISTS Placekicker Alex McPherson enters his senior season as a Lou Groza Award candidate; he holds Auburn's career record for field-goal percentage (88.9). Punter Hudson Kaak enters his second year as the starter, and primary kickoff returner Rayshawn Pleasant is also back.

FINAL ANALYSIS Golesh is relying on imports to get Auburn on track. Brown is certainly capable, and if a remade offensive line holds up, the Tigers should re-enter the top 50 nationally for scoring. If the defensive line transfers hit and returning players keep progressing, that unit could flourish, too. "You're meshing almost two teams into one, and you're looking for leadership in every imaginable way," Golesh says.

2025 RESULTS (5-7, 1-7 SEC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 29	at Baylor	W	38-24	Sept. 5	vs. Baylor #	1. Brady Marchese, WR	★★★★
Sept. 6	Ball State	W	42-3	Sept. 12	Southern Miss	2. Jaquez Wilkes, EDGE	★★★★
Sept. 13	South Alabama	W	31-15	Sept. 19	Florida	3. Wilson Zierer, OT	★★★★
Sept. 20	at Oklahoma	L	17-24	Sept. 26	Vanderbilt	4. Shadarius Toodle, LB	★★★
Sept. 27	at Texas A&M	L	10-16	Oct. 3	at Tennessee	5. Tavian Branch, DL	★★★
Oct. 11	Georgia	L	10-20	Oct. 17	at Georgia	6. Damonte Tabb, S	★★★
Oct. 18	Missouri (ot)	L	17-23	Oct. 24	LSU	7. Adam Balogoun-Ali, LB	★★★
Oct. 25	at Arkansas	W	33-24	Oct. 31	at Ole Miss	8. Brian Williams Jr., WR	★★★
Nov. 1	Kentucky	L	3-10	Nov. 7	Arkansas	9. DJ Broughton Jr., TE	★★★
Nov. 8	at Vanderbilt (ot)	L	38-45	Nov. 14	at Mississippi State	10. Mykall Lundy-Foster, IOL	★★★
Nov. 22	Mercer	W	62-17	Nov. 21	Samford		
Nov. 29	Alabama	L	20-27	Nov. 28	at Alabama		

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Alex Golesh • Record at School: First Season • Career Record: 23-15 (3 years) • Offensive Coordinators: Kodi Burns, Joel Gordon • Defensive Coordinators: DJ Durkin, Tim Banks • Location: Auburn, Ala. • Stadium: Jordan-Hare Stadium (88,043)



JEREMIAH COBB

SCOUTING THE TIGERS

"Honestly, [Alex Golesh] is a pretty good fit. You see him paired with [defensive coordinator] DJ [Durkin], and he's a grinder. I see how the system could be attractive. You bring your quarterback with you, and there's not a big learning curve there. I could see them having success. ... They were really good on defense last year. They were the best defense that we saw. You add some offense with it, and they can be pretty good. I sense that there's gonna be a mentality to be who they are and not conform to the past and how things have been run there. ... Teams that play them early, there's gonna be a surprise with how efficient they are with the guys that have been in that system."

—An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (1)

WR	5	Chas Nimrod* (Sr.)	13	Kory Pettigrew* (Fr.)
WR	11	Keshaun Singleton* (Jr.)	6	Bryce Cain (So.)
WR	4	Jeremiah Koger* (So.)	8	Christian Neptune* (So.)
LT	65	Stanton Ramil* (Jr.)	71	Tai Buster (Fr.)
LG	52	Deryc Plazz* (So.)	76	Jack Leyrer* (Sr.)
C	72	Cole Best* (Sr.)	51	Kail Ellis (So.)
RG	56	Cole Skinner* (Sr.)	74	Jacobe Ward (Fr.)
RT	79	Jo Simmons* (Sr.)	77	Wilson Zierer (Fr.)
TE	19	Jake Johnson* (Sr.)	1	Jonathan Echols* (So.)
QB	17	Byrum Brown* (Sr.)	3	Locklan Hewlett* (Fr.)
RB	23	JEREMIAH COBB (SR.)	30	Bryson Washington* (Jr.)

DEFENSE (1)

DE	90	Nate Johnson* (Sr.)	11	Darrion Smith (So.)
DT	94	Cody Sigler* (Sr.)	99	Saint Farrior* (Jr.)
DT	10	Walter Mathis Jr.* (So.)	35	Dallas Walker IV (Sr.)
DE	15	Da'Shawn Womack* (Sr.)	41	Jared Smith (So.)
LB	17	XAVIER ATKINS (JR.)	44	Adam Balogoun-Ali (Fr.)
LB	9	Elijah Melendez (So.)	51	Michael Matthews-Canty* (Jr.)
LB	16	Bryce Deas (So.)	6	Demarcus Riddick (Jr.)
CB	22	Andre Jordan Jr.* (Sr.)	33	Kamari Todd* (So.)
CB	4	Rayshawn Pleasant (Sr.)	14	Shamar Arnoux* (So.)
S	23	Fred Gaskin III* (Jr.)	0	Sylvester Smith (Jr.)
S	5	Eric Winters (So.)	3	AnQuon Fegans (So.)

SPECIALISTS

K	38	Alex McPherson (Sr.)	KR	4	Rayshawn Pleasant (Sr.)
P	14	Hudson Kaak (Sr.)	PR	6	Bryce Cain (So.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



JADAN BAUGH

SCOUTING THE GATORS

"[Jon Sumrall] has hired extremely well. It feels like they've really opened up the checkbook. ... The question marks would still be along the offensive line and quarterback. They got [Aaron Philo] from Georgia Tech, who knows the system, but in this league, it's about making critical throws on third down and in the red zone, and that's yet to be seen. ... Hiring [offensive coordinator] Buster Faulkner was a home-run move. Then getting Philo to come with him, and getting [Auburn wide receiver transfer] Eric Singleton, too. ... Faulkner can coach offensive football. It is such a departure from what anybody in the SEC does offensively, and they're gonna have a couple games where they have an advantage because everything is so new schematically."

—An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (3)

WR	6	Dallas Wilson (Fr.)	5	Micah Mays Jr.* (Jr.)
WR	1	Vernell Brown III (So.)	3	Bailey Stockton* (Jr.)
WR	2	Eric Singleton Jr.* (Sr.)	4	TJ Abrams (So.)
LT	66	Emeka Ugorji* (So.)	55	TJ Dice Jr. (Fr.)
LG	77	KNJIEAH HARRIS (SR.)	61	G'Nivre Carr (Fr.)
C	52	Harrison Moore* (Jr.)	50	Jason Zandamela (So.)
RG	67	TJ Shanahan Jr.* (Jr.)	53	Bryce Lovett (Jr.)
RT	63	CADEN JONES (JR.)	64	Eagan Boyer* (So.)
TE	15	Luke Harpring* (So.)	7	Amir Jackson (So.)
QB	12	Aaron Philo* (So.)	9	Tramell Jones Jr. (Fr.)
RB	13	JADAN BAUGH (JR.)	20	Duke Clark (Fr.)

DEFENSE (3)

DE	11	LJ McCray (So.)	24	Kamran James (Sr.)
DT	91	Jeremiah McCloud (So.)	97	Joseph Mbatchou (So.)
DT	90	Brendan Bett (Jr.)	99	Emmanuel Oyejedejo* (Sr.)
JACK	0	Jayden Woods (So.)	14	KJ Ford (Fr.)
LB	8	Aaron Chiles (Jr.)	50	Malik Morris (Fr.)
LB	5	MYLES GRAHAM (JR.)	7	Ty Jackson (So.)
LB	29	JADEN ROBINSON (SR.)	44	Myles Johnson (So.)
CB	12	Ben Hanks III (Fr.)	25	Cormani McClain (Jr.)
CB	27	Dijon Johnson (Jr.)	6	J'Vari Flowers (So.)
S	1	BJCE THORNTON (SR.)	2	Lagonza Hayward (So.)
S	33	DJ Coleman* (Sr.)	10	Cam Dooley* (Jr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	91	Patrick Durkin* (So.)	KR	1	Vernell Brown III (So.)
P	38	Alec Clark* (Jr.)	PR	24	London Montgomery* (Jr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



FLORIDA GATORS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 26 | SEC PREDICTION: 9 | 2025 RECORD: 4-8, 2-6 SEC

OFFENSE Florida returns one of the SEC's top tailbacks in Jadan Baugh, along with potential rising stars in receivers Vernell Brown III and Dallas Wilson. New head coach Jon Sumrall also inherited an offense that managed only one touchdown in five different losses. Sumrall hired innovative offensive coordinator Buster Faulkner from Georgia Tech to restore production and excitement at a program accustomed to both during its heyday. Faulkner brought quarterback Aaron Philo, the Yellow Jackets' former backup, to compete with returning redshirt freshman Tramell Jones Jr. for the starting job that opened up when DJ Lagway transferred to Baylor.

Receiver Eric Singleton Jr., who played for Faulkner in 2023-24 at Tech, arrives from Auburn to headline a wave of portal additions. The group includes spring game standout Micah Mays Jr. (Wake Forest) and Cincinnati tailback Evan Pryor, a home-run threat as a runner and receiver.

Up front, transfers TJ Shanahan Jr. (Penn State/Texas A&M), Harrison Moore (Georgia Tech) and Emeka Ugorji (Stanford), along with three-year starting guard Knijeah Harris, are key to building a reliable line.

DEFENSE Florida could field its best front seven since 2019, when the Gators allowed just 15.5 points per game. Linebackers Myles Graham, Jaden Robinson and Aaron Chiles, edge rusher Jayden Woods, tackle Brendan Bett and end Kamran James anchor a talented, experienced group capable of setting the tone defensively in the 3-4 scheme that defensive coordinator Brad White brought from Kentucky.

End LJ McCray has star potential but must stay healthy after logging only four snaps in 2025. Tackles Joseph Mbatchou and Jeremiah McCloud look poised for Year 2 jumps after flashing as freshmen. Jacksonville State transfer Emmanuel Oyejedejo adds size (6-foot-6, 303) and athleticism.

The secondary remains less certain. Redshirt freshman Ben Hanks III impressed in the spring, while veterans Dijon Johnson and Cormani McClain must find consistency. Safety Bryce Thornton is a proven playmaker, while Baylor transfer DJ Coleman adds needed physicality.

SPECIALISTS Patrick Durkin, who made 25-of-28 field goals in 2025, and Alec Clark (46.5 yards per punt) followed Sumrall from Tulane. Brown adds a dangerous return element.

FINAL ANALYSIS Sumrall's teams reached the conference title game two times apiece at Troy and Tulane and won at least 11 games three times. He brought strength coach Rusty Whitt, a former Green Beret, to instill toughness and culture. Florida's fourth head coach since 2017, Sumrall faces roster holes and NIL challenges, but if he's the right hire, the 43-year-old could awaken a program he called "a sleeping giant."

2025 RESULTS (4-8, 2-6 SEC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 30	Long Island	W	55-0	Sept. 5	Florida Atlantic	1. CJ Bronaugh, CB	★★★★
Sept. 6	South Florida	L	16-18	Sept. 12	Campbell	2. Tyler Chukuyem, OT	★★★★
Sept. 13	at LSU	L	10-20	Sept. 19	at Auburn	3. Davian Groce, WR	★★★★
Sept. 20	at Miami (Fla.)	L	7-26	Sept. 26	Ole Miss	4. KJ Ford, EDGE	★★★★
Oct. 4	Texas	W	29-21	Oct. 3	at Missouri	5. Justin Williams, WR	★★★★
Oct. 11	at Texas A&M	L	17-34	Oct. 10	South Carolina	6. Dylan Purter, S	★★★★
Oct. 18	Mississippi State	W	23-21	Oct. 17	at Texas	7. Ja'Reylan McCoy, DL	★★★★
Nov. 1	vs. Georgia #	L	20-24	Oct. 31	vs. Georgia #	8. Will Griffin, QB	★★★★
Nov. 8	at Kentucky	L	7-38	Nov. 7	Oklahoma	9. Heze Kent, OT	★★★
Nov. 15	at Ole Miss	L	24-34	Nov. 14	at Kentucky	10. Kaiden Hall, S	★★★
Nov. 22	Tennessee	L	11-31	Nov. 21	Vanderbilt		
Nov. 29	Florida State	W	40-21	Nov. 28	at Florida State		
#Jacksonville, FL				#Atlanta		*Per Rivals	

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Jon Sumrall • Record at School: First Season • Career Record: 43-12 (4 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Buster Faulkner • Defensive Coordinator: Brad White • Location: Gainesville, Fla. • Stadium: Ben Hill Griffin Stadium (88,548)



GEORGIA BULLDOGS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 2 | SEC PREDICTION: 1 | 2025 RECORD: 12-2, 7-1 SEC

OFFENSE It's Year 2 for quarterback Gunner Stockton. Last season saw him serve as a difference-maker in a few big Georgia wins, but it also saw him hamstringing the offense at different points when he wasn't at his best. Stockton has to shrink the gap between his ceiling and his floor.

The backfield is loaded. Nate Frazier returns as the team's lead back. Chauncey Bowens, Dante Dowdell and Dwight Phillips Jr. have each shown the ability to generate big plays.

At receiver, the Bulldogs grabbed Isiah Canion (Georgia Tech) out of the transfer portal for experience, but they'll lean on a talented, explosive group of youngsters, including Talyn Taylor and Landon Roldan. London Humphreys brings big-game experience. A deep, extremely talented group of tight ends will also carry some of the load.

The offensive line brings back four players with significant experience. True freshman Zykie Helton and 6-foot-10 junior Jahzare Jackson also stepped up this spring. Those two are vying for the No. 5 and No. 6 spots in the trenches, with Juan Gaston ready to play right guard or right tackle.

DEFENSE The Bulldogs bring back 21 defenders who played meaningful action either at UGA or another program last season. Fourth-year junior Xzavier McLeod and ultra-talented sophomore Elijah Griffin anchor the defensive front.

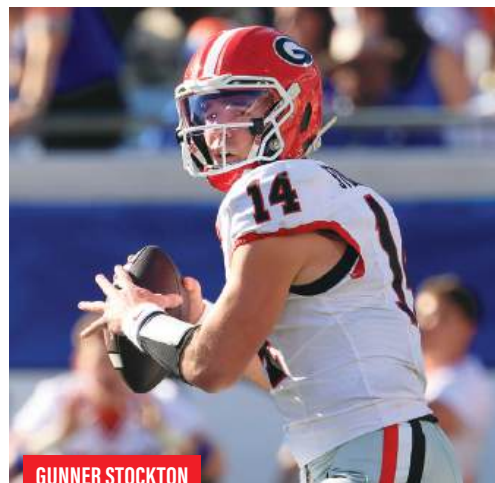
The pass rush is a priority, and that's where edge Quintavius Johnson is looking to take a big step forward. Georgia brought in pass-rush technician Larry Knight as outside linebackers coach to get the best out of Johnson and redshirt freshman Chase Linton, who had a breakout spring.

Inside linebacker features the three-headed monster of Raylen Wilson, Chris Cole and Justin Williams. UGA is set at cornerback, led by Ellis Robinson IV, but the safety spot alongside KJ Bolden is up for grabs. Clemson transfer Khalil Barnes figures to start either there or at the Star/nickel spot.

SPECIALISTS Drew Miller, a redshirt sophomore, is a big, strong-legged punter who is praised for his hang time and work ethic. Peyton Woodring is going into his fourth season as placekicker. He is as reliable as they come, including in big moments. Wide receiver Sacovie White-Helton is aiming to replace Zachariah Branch as the punt returner.

FINAL ANALYSIS The Bulldogs were young a season ago, relying on a lot of second- and third-year players. That group is now a year older, and as we've seen since 2019, experienced teams thrive in this era of college football. But the Bulldogs will go only as far as Stockton will take them.

2025 RESULTS (12-2, 7-1 SEC)			2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 30	Marshall	W 45-7	Sept. 5	Tennessee State	1. Ekene Ogboko, OT	★★★★★
Sept. 6	Austin Peay	W 28-6	Sept. 12	Western Kentucky	2. Craig Dandridge, WR	★★★★
Sept. 13	at Tennessee (ot)	W 44-41	Sept. 19	at Arkansas	3. Kaiden Prothro, TE	★★★★
Sept. 27	Alabama	L 21-24	Sept. 26	Oklahoma	4. Justice Fitzpatrick, CB	★★★★
Oct. 4	Kentucky	W 35-14	Oct. 3	Vanderbilt	5. Khamari Brooks, EDGE	★★★★
Oct. 11	at Auburn	W 20-10	Oct. 10	at Alabama	6. Tyriq Green, S	★★★★
Oct. 18	Ole Miss	W 43-35	Oct. 17	Auburn	7. Jordan Smith, S	★★★★
Nov. 1	vs. Florida #	W 24-20	Oct. 31	vs. Florida #	8. Caden Harris, CB	★★★★
Nov. 8	at Mississippi State	W 41-21	Nov. 7	at Ole Miss	9. Tyreek Jemison, IOL	★★★★
Nov. 15	Texas	W 35-10	Nov. 14	Missouri	10. Valdin Sone, DL	★★★★
Nov. 22	Charlotte	W 35-3	Nov. 21	at South Carolina		
Nov. 28	at Georgia Tech	W 16-9	Nov. 28	Georgia Tech		
Dec. 6	vs. Alabama %	W 28-7		#Atlanta		*Per Rivals
Jan. 1	vs. Ole Miss &	L 34-39				
#Jacksonville, FL %Atlanta						
&Sugar Bowl: CFB Playoff Quarterfinal						
TEAM INFORMATION						
Head Coach: Kirby Smart • Record at School: 117-21 (10 years)						
Career Record: 117-21 (10 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Mike Bobo						
Defensive Coordinator: Glenn Schumann • Location: Athens, Ga.						
Stadium: Sanford Stadium (93,033)						



GUNNER STOCKTON

SCOUTING THE BULLDOGS

"Do they still have the depth that they had in 2020? I think the answer to that is 'no.' Those backups or third-string guys are playing for Missouri or Georgia Tech. I don't know that their process is the same. I don't know that their depth is the same. Are those elite programs getting better? Probably not. They have a thinner margin for error. ... They'll look really similar to how they looked this past year. I think they'll be a playoff team, but I don't know that they're an elite SEC team like the ones you saw in the early 2020s. What they seek to be offensively is 'Don't blow the game. Let's run the ball. Let's let the quarterback get in the rhythm.' ... Their confidence in [QB Gunner Stockton] throwing the ball will determine how aggressive they are."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (6)

WR	6	Isiah Canion* (Jr.)	8	Landon Roldan (So.)
WR	1	Talyn Taylor (Fr.)	16	London Humphreys (Sr.)
WR	0	Sacovie White-Helton (So.)	13	Tyler J. Williams (Fr.)
LT	71	EARNEST GREENE III (SR.)	72	Ekene Ogboko (Fr.)
LG	63	DONTRELL GLOVER (SO.)	70	Daniel Calhoun (So.)
C	74	DREW BOBO (SR.)	50	Cortez Smith (Fr.)
RG	55	Zykie Helton (Fr.)	52	Michael Uini (So.)
RT	73	Juan Gaston (So.)	64	Jahzare Jackson (Jr.)
TE	7	LAWSON LUCKIE (SR.)	10	Elyiss Williams (So.)
QB	14	GUNNER STOCKTON (SR.)	12	Ryan Puglisi (So.)
RB	3	NATE FRAZIER (JR.)	5	Chauncey Bowens (So.)

DEFENSE (8)

DE	0	GABE HARRIS JR. (SR.)	99	Joseph Jonah-Ajonye (So.)
NT	94	XZAVIER MCLEOD (JR.)	95	Nnamdi Ogboko (So.)
DT	90	Elijah Griffin (So.)	44	JORDAN HALL (JR.)
OLB	3	QUINTAVIUS JOHNSON (JR.)	85	Chase Linton (Fr.)
ILB	9	Chris Cole (Jr.)	19	Justin Williams (Jr.)
ILB	5	RAYLEN WILSON (SR.)	10	Zayden Walker (So.)
CB	1	ELLIS ROBINSON IV (SO.)	26	Gentry Williams* (Sr.)
CB	15	Demello Jones (Jr.)	24	Braylon Conley* (So.)
STAR	7	Khalil Barnes* (Sr.)	23	Tyriq Green (Fr.)
S	4	KJ BOLDEN (JR.)	12	Ja'Marley Riddle* (Jr.)
S	27	Rasean Dinkins (So.)	31	KYRON JONES (JR.)

SPECIALISTS

K	91	Peyton Woodring (Sr.)	KR	1	Talyn Taylor (Fr.)
P	90	Drew Miller (So.)	PR	0	Sacovie White-Helton (So.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER

COREY PERRINE/FLORENCE TIMES-JOURNAL



TY BRYANT

SCOUTING THE WILDCATS

"With the talent base that [new head coach Will Stein] inherited, the only thing I wonder about is the fact that he had more talent than everybody else at Oregon for most of the games. It'll be interesting to see him going from one of the haves to one of the have-nots and how that's going to transition while still not losing your enthusiasm, your connection with the players and all of those kinds of things. ... I haven't seen a ton of [Notre Dame QB transfer Kenny Minchey], but I've heard good things about him as an athlete and as a person. He clearly has legit talent, and those guys are hard to find."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (1)

WR	4	Nic Anderson* (Sr.)	5	Ja'Kayden Ferguson* (So.)
WR	7	DJ Miller (So.)	17	Hardley Gilmore IV (Jr.)
WR	6	Shane Carr* (Jr.)	19	Kenny Darby (Fr.)
LT	53	Lance Heard* (Sr.)	67	Mark Robinson* (Jr.)
LG	73	Olaus Alinen* (Jr.)	57	Jordan Knox* (Jr.)
C	72	Coleton Price* (Sr.)	79	Jay Clark (Fr.)
RG	77	Tegra Tshabola* (Sr.)	55	Aba Selm (So.)
RT	71	Malachi Wood (Jr.)	50	Max Anderson* (So.)
TE	81	WILLIE RODRIGUEZ (JR.)	87	Henry Boyer (Sr.)
QB	3	Kenny Minchey* (Jr.)	14	Brennen Ward (So.)
RB	1	CJ Baxter* (Jr.)	2	Jovantae Barnes* (Sr.)

DEFENSE (3)

DE	90	MI'QUISE HUMPHREY-GRACE (SR.)	6	Ahmad Breaux* (Jr.)
DT	7	Jamarrion Harkless* (Jr.)	93	Kalen Edwards (So.)
DT	94	Tavion Gadson (Jr.)	91	Jaden Williams (Sr.)
OLB	2	SAM GREENE (JR.)	8	Lorenzo Cowan (So.)
ILB	22	Grant Godfrey (Jr.)	25	Tavion Wallace* (So.)
ILB	0	Elijah Barnes* (Fr.)	44	Antwan Smith (Jr.)
CB	20	Terhyon Nichols (Jr.)	30	Grant Grayton (So.)
CB	12	Hasaan Sykes* (Jr.)	21	Nasir Addison (Sr.)
NB	3	Aaron Gates* (Jr.)	24	Jaden Smith (So.)
S	14	TY BRYANT (SR.)	13	Cyrus Reyes* (Jr.)
S	5	Jordan Castell* (Sr.)	16	Jesse Anderson III* (Jr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	91	Jacob Kauwe (So.)	KR	19	Kenny Darby (Fr.)
P	48	Thomas O'Hara* (Jr.)	PR	4	Martels Carter Jr. (Fr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN **BOLD** • *2026 TRANSFER



KENTUCKY WILDCATS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 49 | SEC PREDICTION: 15 | 2025 RECORD: 5-7, 2-6 SEC

OFFENSE When a school fires its head coach, it usually searches for a contrasting style. That is the case for Kentucky, which replaced Mark Stoops with Oregon offensive coordinator Will Stein to bring a more exciting attack to Lexington.

Former Notre Dame backup Kenny Minchey will start at quarterback. The staff added three offensive line starters with multiple years of power-conference starting experience. Former starters at Oklahoma and Texas will be among the featured options at running back and wide receiver.

If the staff's gamble on Minchey, who narrowly lost the Notre Dame starting job a year ago but has played few meaningful snaps in three college seasons, pays off, the offense could be Kentucky's best in years. That quest would be helped with breakout seasons from returning pass-catchers DJ Miller and Willie Rodriguez.

Health will be a key storyline to watch since running backs CJ Baxter and Jovantae Barnes and wide receiver Nic Anderson all showed talent at their previous schools but lacked recent production due to injuries.

DEFENSE Stein hired former Texas A&M defensive coordinator Jay Bateman, promising him more autonomy. Bateman's scheme promises more pass-rushing opportunities and press-man coverage.

The new staff kept many of the key defenders from 2025, including line-men Mi'Quise Humphrey-Grace and Tavion Gadson, edge rusher Sam Greene, linebacker Grant Godfrey, cornerback Terhyon Nichols and safety Ty Bryant. Kentucky added eight transfers in the front seven but chose to pursue potential rather than proven production at linebacker, with the additions of former blue-chippers Elijah Barnes and Tavion Wallace.

Florida transfers Jordan Castell and Aaron Gates will strengthen the secondary, but cornerback is a position to watch. Injuries decimated the position last season, giving younger players game experience before they were ready. The new staff will hope that experience helps in 2026, along with the addition of FCS Western Carolina transfer Hasaan Sykes.

SPECIALISTS Placekicker Jacob Kauwe should be a weapon for the Wildcats. Fans were glad to see the coaches sign Australian punter Thomas O'Hara after the previous staff moved away from rugby-style punters.

FINAL ANALYSIS The new staff has not shied away from the idea that Indiana's championship gives more hope to traditional afterthoughts like Kentucky, but Indiana won big by making the right coaching hire. Stein has to prove that Kentucky did the same in taking a risk on the 36-year-old, first-time head coach who grew up rooting for the Wildcats. If his confidence is warranted, Kentucky could be a sleeper to watch.

2025 RESULTS (5-7, 2-6 SEC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 30	Toledo	W	24-16	Sept. 5	Youngstown State	1. Kenny Darby, WR	★★★★
Sept. 6	Ole Miss	L	23-30	Sept. 12	Alabama	2. Matt Ponatoski, QB	★★★★
Sept. 13	Eastern Michigan	W	48-23	Sept. 19	at Texas A&M	3. Isaiah McMillian, CB	★★★★
Sept. 27	at South Carolina	L	13-35	Sept. 26	South Alabama	4. Justyn Hartley, LB	★★★★
Oct. 4	at Georgia	L	14-35	Oct. 3	at South Carolina	5. Ben Duncum, EDGE	★★★★
Oct. 18	Texas (ot)	L	13-16	Oct. 10	LSU	6. Prince Jean, WR	★★★
Oct. 25	Tennessee	L	34-56	Oct. 17	at Oklahoma	7. Lincoln Watkins, TE	★★★
Nov. 1	at Auburn	W	10-3	Oct. 24	Vanderbilt	8. Cameron Miller Jr., OT	★★★
Nov. 8	Florida	W	38-7	Nov. 7	at Tennessee	9. Andre Clarke Jr., CB	★★★
Nov. 15	Tennessee Tech	W	42-10	Nov. 14	Florida	10. Denairius Gray, WR	★★★
Nov. 22	at Vanderbilt	L	17-45	Nov. 21	at Missouri		
Nov. 29	at Louisville	L	0-41	Nov. 28	Louisville		

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Will Stein • Record at School: First Season • Career Record: First Season • Offensive Coordinator: Joe Sloan
Defensive Coordinator: Jay Bateman • Location: Lexington, Ky. • Stadium: Kroger Field (61,000)

OFFENSE Head coach Lane Kiffin's abrupt departure from Ole Miss for LSU on the cusp of the College Football Playoff was nationwide media fodder last fall. For LSU to be the talk of college football this season, Kiffin must take a team with 59 newcomers (including 43 transfers) and mold it into a cohesive unit. It starts with quarterback Sam Leavitt, who spent much of the offseason recovering from November foot surgery while at Arizona State. Leavitt has amassed more than 5,400 total yards and 46 total touchdowns in 24 games combined at ASU and Michigan State.

Leavitt will have a bevy of unfamiliar receivers to throw to, led by Florida's Eugene Wilson III (61 catches, 538 yards, six TDs in 2023), with the top left tackle in the portal, Jordan Seaton from Colorado, protecting his blind side. LSU has a slew of new running backs, too, but persuading Harlem Berry and Caden Durham to return was a major coup.

The X-factor could be returning tight end Trey'Dez Green (33 catches, 433 yards, seven TDs in 2025). One could see the wheels in Kiffin's head turning during the offseason as he dreamed up mismatches for the 6-foot-7 Green to exploit.

DEFENSE Kiffin got players like top-rated portal edge rusher Princewill Umanmielen (tied for third in the SEC with 9.0 sacks) and linebacker TJ Dottery (SEC-best 98 tackles) to follow him from Ole Miss, and safety Ty Benefield from Boise State (107 tackles) should be an instant starter.

But the story of LSU's defense is retention. Returning are linebacker Whit Weeks — though he was slowly recovering from a broken ankle suffered against Ole Miss — and cornerback DJ Pickett, the heir apparent to departed All-American Mansoor Delane. Another key returnee is defensive coordinator Blake Baker. The continuity on that side of the ball will be critical to the Tigers' hopes as Kiffin remakes the offense.

SPECIALISTS Grant Chadwick returns as LSU's punter after ranking second in the SEC in 2025 with a 45.7-yard average. Scott Starzyk from Arkansas is expected to slide into the placekicking role vacated by Damian Ramos, who graduated with numerous LSU records. Starzyk was a Freshman All-SEC pick last season, making 14-of-18 field goals and all 47 of his extra points.

FINAL ANALYSIS No question Kiffin has a great staff, which has assembled a great roster. But to be a playoff team for the first time since 2019, the Tigers must be more than a collection of talent. "It takes a ton of work to get a program back to where everyone here wants it to be," Kiffin says. With so many newcomers, not even Kiffin knows whether all that work will pay off.

2025 RESULTS (7-6, 3-5 SEC)	2026 SCHEDULE	TOP 10 RECRUITS*
Aug. 30 at Clemson W 17-10	Sept. 5 Clemson	1. Lamar Brown, DL ★★★★★
Sept. 6 Louisiana Tech W 23-7	Sept. 12 Louisiana Tech	2. Richard Anderson, DL ★★★★★
Sept. 13 Florida W 20-10	Sept. 19 at Ole Miss	3. Corey Barber Jr., WR ★★★★★
Sept. 20 SE Louisiana W 56-10	Sept. 26 Texas A&M	4. Deuce Gerals, DL ★★★★★
Sept. 27 at Ole Miss L 19-24	Oct. 3 McNeese	5. Trenton Henderson, EDGE ★★★★★
Oct. 11 South Carolina W 20-10	Oct. 10 at Kentucky	6. Brysten Martinez, OT ★★★★★
Oct. 18 at Vanderbilt L 24-31	Oct. 17 Mississippi State	7. Havon Finney Jr., CB ★★★★★
Oct. 25 Texas A&M L 25-49	Oct. 24 at Auburn	8. Brayden Allen, WR ★★★★★
Nov. 8 at Alabama L 9-20	Nov. 7 Alabama	9. Jabari Mack, WR ★★★★★
Nov. 15 Arkansas W 23-22	Nov. 14 Texas	10. Isaiah Washington, S ★★★★★
Nov. 22 WKU W 13-10	Nov. 21 at Tennessee	
Nov. 29 at Oklahoma L 13-17	Nov. 28 at Arkansas	<i>*Per Rivals</i>
Dec. 27 vs. Houston # L 35-38		
#Texas Bowl		
TEAM INFORMATION		
Head Coach: Lane Kiffin • Record at School: First Season		
Career Record: 116-53 (13+ years) • Offensive Coordinators: Charlie Weis Jr., Joe Cox • Defensive Coordinators: Blake Baker, Chris Kiffin		
Location: Baton Rouge, La. • Stadium: Tiger Stadium (102,321)		



TREY'DEZ GREEN

SCOUTING THE TIGERS

"Any offense that Lane [Kiffin] has had, they've been unique, they've been multiple, they've been unconventional. Schematically, with [offensive coordinator] Charlie Weis Jr., I think they're gonna make people play 11-on-11 football. I could see them easily getting back to doing what LSU does. It's gonna be a four-quarter game against those guys every time you play them with the tempo and the athletes they always have. ... [LSU defensive coordinator] Blake Baker does such a great job of messing with a quarterback's eyes. He's a really big pain on third down. Ultimately, it's about what you can get your quarterback to know, and [Baker] makes it really hard on quarterbacks with what they think they see and what the reality is."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (3)

WR	1	Jayce Brown* (Sr.)	2	Tre' Brown* (Jr.)
WR	3	Eugene Wilson III* (Jr.)	6	Winston Watkins Jr.* (So.)
WR	4	Jackson Harris* (Jr.)	88	Malik Elzy* (Jr.)
LT	77	Jordan Seaton* (Jr.)	71	Brysten Martinez (Fr.)
LG	70	Devin Harper* (So.)	52	Ja'Quan Sprinkle* (Jr.)
C	61	BRAELIN MOORE (SR.)	50	William Satterwhite II* (So.)
RG	55	Aliou Bah* (Sr.)	69	Darrin Strey* (Fr.)
RT	75	WESTON DAVIS (SO.)	67	Bo Bordelon (Sr.)
TE	14	TREY'DEZ GREEN (JR.)	12	Malachi Thomas* (Jr.)
QB	10	Sam Leavitt* (Jr.)	6	Husan Longstreet* (Fr.)
RB	22	Harlem Berry (So.)	29	Caden Durham (Jr.)

DEFENSE (3)

DE	1	Princewill Umanmielen* (Sr.)	93	Jaylen Brown* (So.)
DT	90	Stephiylan Green* (Jr.)	47	Malik Blocton* (Jr.)
DT	96	Dominick McKinley (Jr.)	94	Richard Anderson (Fr.)
DE	29	Jordan Ross* (Jr.)	97	Dylan Carpenter (Jr.)
LB	40	WHIT WEEKS (SR.)	6	TJ Dottery* (Sr.)
LB	42	Davhon Keys (Jr.)	35	Zach Weeks (Fr.)
CB	11	PJ WOODLAND (JR.)	8	Ja'Keem Jackson (Jr.)
CB	3	DJ Pickett (So.)	21	Michael Turner Jr. (So.)
STAR	10	Dashawn Spears (Jr.)	26	Charles Ross II (So.)
S	2	Ty Benefield* (Sr.)	28	Jhase Thomas (Fr.)
S	0	TAMARCUS COOLEY (JR.)	13	Faheem Delane* (So.)

SPECIALISTS

K	80	Scott Starzyk* (So.)	KR	85	Josh Jackson* (So.)
P	90	Grant Chadwick (Jr.)	PR	85	Josh Jackson* (So.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



KAMARIO TAYLOR

SCOUTING THE BULLDOGS

"Bringing back [defensive coordinator] Zach Arnett was a tremendous hire. Every single time his defense shows up, it's an anomaly for offenses. They don't see it week to week, and the way they run it and the aggressiveness behind it create problems. The thing they don't have there is the ability to sign two to four elite defensive tackles every year. Well, in that scheme, you just have to have one. They can have success without having to do what everybody else in the SEC has to do with a four-down front. ... [QB Kamario Taylor] is a phenom. He's athletically gifted. He can do a lot of things for them this year, not only with his arm, but also with his feet. He can keep plays alive, which turn into big plays."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (3)

WR	2	Marquis Johnson* (Sr.)	13	Sanfrisco Magee (So.)
WR	11	Ayden Williams (Sr.)	0	Gracen Harris (Fr.)
WR	3	ANTHONY EVANS III (SR.)	7	Zion Ragins* (So.)
LT	58	Miles McVay* (Jr.)	71	Saquon Miles (Jr.)
LG	78	DJ Chester* (Jr.)	54	BLAKE STEEN (JR.)
C	72	CANON BOONE (SR.)	63	Mario Nash* (Fr.)
RG	50	LJ Prudhomme* (Fr.)	77	TJ Lockhart (So.)
RT	55	Jakheem Shumpert-Perkins (Jr.)	75	Isaiah Dent* (So.)
TE	87	Sam West (Jr.)	18	Riley Williams* (Jr.)
QB	1	Kamario Taylor (So.)	17	AJ Swann* (Sr.)
RB	24	Fluff Bothwell (Jr.)	5	Xavier Gayten (Jr.)

DEFENSE (6)

DE	43	Will Whitson (Sr.)	97	Jayson Jenkins* (Sr.)
DT	35	KALVIN DINKINS (SR.)	9	JARAY BLEDSOE (SR.)
DT	42	DJ Reed (Jr.)	14	Dealyn Evans* (So.)
EDGE	4	AMAREE WILLIAMS* (JR.)	16	Derion Gullette (Jr.)
LB	10	JALEN SMITH (JR.)	0	Fatt Forrest (So.)
LB	7	ZAKARI TILLMAN (SR.)	44	Gav Holman* (So.)
LB	11	Tyler Lockhart (So.)	13	LaKendrick James (Jr.)
CB	1	KELLEY JONES (JR.)	8	Kaylib Singleton* (Fr.)
CB	20	Jett Jefferson (Jr.)	24	Quentin Taylor* (So.)
S	5	Jardin Gilbert* (Sr.)	28	Tanner Johnson (Sr.)
S	2	Isaac Smith (Sr.)	15	Marcus Williams* (Sr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	80	Kyle Ferrie (Sr.)	KR	2	Marquis Johnson* (Sr.)
P	88	Ethan Pulliam (Jr.)	PR	3	Anthony Evans III (Sr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



MISSISSIPPI STATE BULLDOGS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 44 | SEC PREDICTION: 13 | 2025 RECORD: 5-8, 1-7 SEC

OFFENSE There is optimism at Mississippi State, and much of it comes courtesy of the Bulldogs' ultra-talented sophomore quarterback Kamario Taylor. The highest-rated quarterback recruit in program history flashed last season, winning a pair of SEC Freshman of the Week awards on his way to becoming the team's starter by the regular-season finale and then passing for 241 yards and a touchdown in the Duke's Mayo Bowl loss to Wake Forest.

The dual-threat signal-caller is surrounded by talent at the skill positions. Running back Fluff Bothwell looks for a fully healthy year after injury derailed a great start to 2025. The receiver room has depth and always seems to find playmakers under head coach Jeff Lebby. However, a big question mark surrounds MSU's offensive line play after that unit's inconsistencies hampered State far too often last season.

DEFENSE MSU's defense has been its biggest stumbling block the past two seasons, finishing last or next to last in the SEC in total defense both years. Lebby has brought back former State head coach and defensive coordinator Zach Arnett to try to restore order on that side of the ball. Arnett shined in his previous stint as defensive coordinator at State from 2020 through 2022. MSU finished fifth in the SEC in total defense in each of those seasons.

To get back to that level of success, the Bulldogs will need an improved pass rush — something that seems likely given Arnett's aggressive tendencies. They'll also look for stronger secondary play and have the pieces to get it, including senior safety Isaac Smith and corner Kelley Jones, who could very well play his way into the first round of the 2027 NFL Draft.

SPECIALISTS The Bulldogs bring back one of their most consistent place-kickers of all time in senior Kyle Ferrie. Ferrie set State's all-time career scoring record for a kicker last season, and he now stands at fourth in program history for career points. Junior Ethan Pulliam, a former two-sport star at MSU, is back to punt for the Bulldogs. State has multiple speedy kick return options, from the returning Anthony Evans III, to transfer Marquis Johnson, to redshirt freshman Kolin Wilson.

FINAL ANALYSIS On paper, this is the most talented roster of the Lebby era at Mississippi State, and the group certainly has the potential to take another step forward after jumping from two wins in 2024 to five victories last season. If the offensive line is simply adequate (or better) and the Bulldogs can improve to somewhere around the middle of the pack in the SEC defensively, the cowbells could clang louder than they have in recent years in Starkville.

2025 RESULTS (5-8, 1-7 SEC)

Aug. 30	at Southern Miss	W	34-17
Sept. 6	Arizona State	W	24-20
Sept. 13	Alcorn	W	63-0
Sept. 20	Northern Illinois	W	38-10
Sept. 27	Tennessee (ot)	L	34-41
Oct. 4	at Texas A&M	L	9-31
Oct. 18	at Florida	L	21-23
Oct. 25	Texas (ot)	L	38-45
Nov. 1	at Arkansas	W	38-35
Nov. 8	Georgia	L	21-41
Nov. 15	at Missouri	L	27-49
Nov. 28	Ole Miss	L	19-38
Jan. 2	vs. Wake Forest #	L	29-43

#Duke's Mayo Bowl

2026 SCHEDULE

Sept. 5	ULM
Sept. 12	at Minnesota
Sept. 19	at South Carolina
Sept. 26	Missouri
Oct. 3	Alabama
Oct. 17	at LSU
Oct. 24	Oklahoma
Oct. 31	at Texas
Nov. 7	Vanderbilt
Nov. 14	Auburn
Nov. 21	Tennessee Tech
Nov. 28	at Ole Miss

TOP 10 RECRUITS*

1.	Micah Nickerson, EDGE	★★★★
2.	Bralan Womack, S	★★★★
3.	Zayion Cotton, TE	★★★★
4.	Jayden Cration, WR	★★★★
5.	Zion Crumpton, WR	★★★★
6.	Terrell Johnson Jr., CB	★★★★
7.	Tico Crittendon Jr., DL	★★★★
8.	Junior Henderson, WR	★★★★
9.	Dalton Toothman, IOL	★★★★
10.	Cooper Crosby, RB	★★★★

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Jeff Lebby • Record at School: 7-18 (2 years)
Career Record: 7-18 (2 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Philip Montgomery
Defensive Coordinators: Zach Arnett, Matt Brock • Location: Starkville, Miss.
Stadium: Davis Wade Stadium (60,311)



MISSOURI TIGERS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 29 | SEC PREDICTION: 11 | 2025 RECORD: 8-5, 4-4 SEC

OFFENSE In eight wins last season, Missouri averaged 41.1 points per game; in five losses, the Tigers averaged 12.8. Mizzou roared out of the gate with an offense driven by Ahmad Hardy's physical running and the controlled passing of Beau Pribula, but the Tigers couldn't control the line of scrimmage as effectively in SEC play, and scoring had already begun to dissipate when Pribula dislocated his ankle against Vanderbilt.

Hardy and Jamal Roberts return after combining for 2,402 rushing yards and 22 touchdowns, and they'll run behind three seniors in all-SEC tackle Cayden Green and guards Dominick Giudice (who could move to center) and Curtis Peagler. But new offensive coordinator Chip Lindsey, most recently of Michigan, must build a passing game from scratch with a new starting quarterback (Ole Miss transfer Austin Simmons) and three new starting receivers. Simmons has a huge arm and beat out Trinidad Chambliss in Ole Miss' fall camp last season, but he threw five interceptions in five games and then lost his job after getting hurt. Mizzou's fate could rest on Simmons cutting down on mistakes.

DEFENSE Missouri allowed just 18.9 points per game last season, its best defensive performance since 2015. Third-year coordinator Corey Batoon will have his work cut out for him in 2026, however: All 11 defenders who started at least seven games are gone. Plenty of experienced players return — end Darris Smith, tackle Marquis Gracial, linebacker Nicholas Rodriguez and safety Santana Banner have all seen starter-level snaps. But head coach Eliah Drinkwitz needed to strike portal gold.

The secondary appears well-stocked with cornerback transfers Chris Graves Jr. (Ole Miss) and Jahlil Florence (Oregon), and linebacker Robert Woodyard Jr. (Auburn) could be a like-for-like replacement for 2025 star Josiah Trotter. Seven defensive linemen arrive via the portal, but none are as proven as three high-profile departures (ends Zion Young and Damon Wilson II and tackle Chris McClellan). If the pass rush regresses too much, that could derail everything.

SPECIALISTS Placekicker Blake Craig suffered a torn ACL in last season's opener, and his backups didn't have his range or reliability. Craig returns, as does return man DaMarion Fowlkes, so improvement is likely over last year's poor special teams showing.

FINAL ANALYSIS Mizzou has won 29 games over the past three seasons, fewer than only Georgia, Texas, Alabama and Ole Miss in the SEC. Drinkwitz's program should be treated as a proven entity of sorts, but between massive defensive turnover and Simmons' all-or-nothing tendencies, Mizzou faces quite a bit of uncertainty in 2026.

2025 RESULTS (8-5, 4-4 SEC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 28	Central Arkansas	W	61-6	Sept. 5	Arkansas-Pine Bluff	1. DJ Jones Jr., OT	★★★★
Sept. 6	Kansas	W	42-31	Sept. 12	at Kansas	2. Braylon Ellison, IOL	★★★★
Sept. 13	Louisiana	W	52-10	Sept. 19	Troy	3. JJ Bush, LB	★★★★
Sept. 20	South Carolina	W	29-20	Sept. 26	at Mississippi State	4. Demarcus Johnson, DL	★★★
Sept. 27	UMass	W	42-6	Oct. 3	Florida	5. Jaxson Gates, CB	★★★
Oct. 11	Alabama	L	24-27	Oct. 10	Texas A&M	6. Brysen Wessell, IOL	★★★
Oct. 18	at Auburn (ot)	W	23-17	Oct. 17	at Ole Miss	7. Tajh Overton, DL	★★★
Oct. 25	at Vanderbilt	L	10-17	Oct. 31	at Arkansas	8. Jayden McGregory, S	★★★
Nov. 8	Texas A&M	L	17-38	Nov. 7	Texas	9. Jabari Brady, WR	★★★
Nov. 15	Mississippi State	W	49-27	Nov. 14	at Georgia	10. Gavin Sidwar, QB	★★★
Nov. 22	at Oklahoma	L	6-17	Nov. 21	Kentucky		
Nov. 29	at Arkansas	W	31-17	Nov. 28	Oklahoma		<i>*Per Rivals</i>
Dec. 27	vs. Virginia #	L	7-13				
#Gator Bowl				TEAM INFORMATION			
				Head Coach: Eliah Drinkwitz • Record at School: 46-29 (6 years)			
				Career Record: 58-30 (7 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Chip Lindsey			
				Defensive Coordinators: Corey Batoon, Derek Nicholson • Location: Columbia, Mo. • Stadium: Faurot Field at Memorial Stadium (57,321)			



AHMAD HARDY

SCOUTING THE TIGERS

"[Ahmad Hardy] is one of the top five running backs in college football in the last decade. That kid is special. Hiring [offensive coordinator] Chip Lindsey was a great hire for who they are and what they're trying to build as a program. They've got really good receivers. Last year, I don't think they could get downfield the way that they wanted to. With [Ole Miss QB transfer Austin Simmons], I think they'll be much better on offense. They'll run what he wants to run. Last year, they ran more gun-run for Beau [Pribula], and Simmons isn't really a gun-run guy. They're really more of a stretch-run and get downfield with a passing tree. This year, they'll be able to do that."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (6)

WR	1	Donovan Olugbode (So.)	4	Shaun Terry II (Fr.)
WR	19	Cayden Lee* (Sr.)	3	DaMarion Fowlkes (So.)
WR	2	Caleb Goodie* (Sr.)	0	Naeshaun Montgomery* (Fr.)
LT	70	CAYDEN GREEN (SR.)	75	Jack Lange (Fr.)
LG	52	Zach Owens* (Sr.)	51	Luke Work* (Jr.)
C	56	DOMINICK GIUDICE (SR.)	73	Tristan Wilson (Sr.)
RG	77	CURTIS PEAGLER (SR.)	79	Brandon Anderson (Fr.)
RT	54	Josh Atkins* (Sr.)	66	Logan Reichert (Jr.)
TE	87	BRETT NORFLEET (SR.)	86	JORDON HARRIS (SR.)
QB	13	Austin Simmons* (Jr.)	5	Matt Zollers (So.)
RB	29	AHMAD HARDY (JR.)	20	Jamal Roberts (Jr.)

DEFENSE (0)

EDGE	19	Darris Smith (Sr.)	29	Kamauryan Morgan* (So.)
DT	3	Marquis Gracial (Sr.)	8	Donta Simpson* (So.)
DT	95	Jalen Marshall (Sr.)		Mark Hensley* (Jr.)
DE	11	Langden Kitchen (Sr.)	13	Jaden Jones* (Sr.)
ILB	5	Nicholas Rodriguez (Jr.)	6	Jeremiah Beasley (Jr.)
ILB	0	Robert Woodyard Jr.* (Sr.)	9	Dante McClellan (So.)
CB	1	Chris Graves Jr.* (Sr.)	20	Cameron Keys (So.)
CB	21	Jahlil Florence* (Sr.)	2	Sione Laulea* (Sr.)
NB	22	Elijah Dotson* (So.)	7	Kensley Louidor-Faustin* (Jr.)
S	15	Santana Banner (Jr.)	18	JaDon Blair* (Fr.)
S	4	Trajen Greco (Jr.)	14	CJ Bass III (Fr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	19	Blake Craig (Jr.)	KR	3	DaMarion Fowlkes (So.)
P	40	Brunno Reus* (Fr.)	PR	3	DaMarion Fowlkes (So.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



JOHN MATEER

SCOUTING THE SOONERS

"[QB John Mateer] has a ridiculously high ceiling. That offense has answers for everything. They don't do a ton, but everything they do complements the other thing. When he just executes and then makes splash plays here and there, they complement their elite defense very well. I was impressed with how [head coach] Brent [Venables] and [general manager] Jim Nagy structured the team, and it feels like they finally hit on what the recipe is to be successful there. ... Defensively, it's so many multiples. Week to week, they won't do the same pre-snap look again, so whatever you prepare for, you're not gonna get. Obviously, you want to create indecision with young quarterbacks or new quarterbacks in the system, and they do that at a really high level."

—An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (6)

WR	3	Parker Livingstone* (So.)	14	Elijah Thomas (So.)
WR	11	Trell Harris* (Sr.)	5	Jer'Michael Carter (Sr.)
WR	1	ISAIAH SATEGNA III (SR.)	17	Mackenzie Alleyne* (So.)
LT	56	MICHAEL FASUSI (SO.)	72	Fred Hinton* (Jr.)
LG	55	Eddy Pierre-Louis (So.)	75	Daniel Akinkunmi (So.)
C	69	JAKE MAIKKULA (SR.)	60	Caleb Nitta* (Jr.)
RG	70	RYAN FODJE (SO.)	77	HEATH OZAETA (JR.)
RT	76	E'Marion Harris* (Sr.)	71	Peyton Joseph* (So.)
TE	89	Hayden Hansen* (Sr.)	81	Rocky Beers* (Sr.)
QB	10	JOHN MATEER (SR.)	16	Whitt Newbauer (So.)
RB	24	Xavier Robinson (Jr.)	6	Tory Blaylock (So.)

DEFENSE (5)

DE	44	TAYLOR WEIN (JR.)	93	Kenny Ozowalu* (So.)
DT	65	Jayden Jackson (Jr.)	2	Nigel Smith II (So.)
DT	0	David Stone (Jr.)	8	Bishop Thomas* (Sr.)
DE	34	Adepoju Adebawore (Sr.)	16	Danny Okoye (So.)
MLB	38	Owen Heinecke (Sr.)	47	James Nesta (So.)
WLB	10	KIP LEWIS (SR.)	28	Marcus James (Fr.)
CHEETAH	18	Cole Sullivan* (Jr.)	3	Reggie Powers III (Jr.)
CB	4	COURTLAND GUILLORY (SO.)	24	Jacobe Johnson (Sr.)
CB	23	ELI BOWEN (JR.)	14	Trystan Haynes (Fr.)
S	22	PEYTON BOWEN (SR.)	2	Omarion Robinson (So.)
S	25	Michael Boganowski (Jr.)	21	Jeremiah Newcombe (So.)

SPECIALISTS

K	29	Tate Sandell (Sr.)	KR	9	Lloyd Avant* (Jr.)
P	43	Grayson Miller (Sr.)	PR	1	Isaiah Sategna III (Sr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



OKLAHOMA SOONERS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 8 | SEC PREDICTION: 3 | 2025 RECORD: 10-3, 6-2 SEC

OFFENSE Quarterback John Mateer's 2025 season was clearly split into pre-thumb-injury and post-thumb-injury segments, with the Sooners failing to reach 400 total yards in a single game after Mateer underwent surgery in late September. However, if an offseason of recovery helps Mateer get back to pre-injury levels, the OU offense could be in for a bigger improvement in coordinator Ben Arbuckle's second season.

OU pushed some young linemen into action, and further progress is expected from them, in particular left tackle Michael Fasusi. Even when Mateer played well last year, the run game had lackluster results, ending the year averaging 3.5 yards per carry. Still, the running back duo of Xavier Robinson and Tory Blaylock possesses the talent to be productive behind more experienced blockers.

The receiver group should see the ball spread to several players once again, but slot Isaiah Sategna III is back as a key target, and transfers Parker Livingstone from Texas and Trell Harris from Virginia Tech look ready to make an immediate impact.

DEFENSE The Sooners had one of the best defenses in the country, allowing 15.5 points and 272.5 yards per game, which is what carried them to the College Football Playoff. The unit lost a couple of pivotal players but returns leading tackler Kip Lewis at linebacker and sacks leader Taylor Wein at defensive end, with other experienced pieces up front.

The Bowen brothers, Peyton and Eli, are back in the secondary after picking off two passes apiece last season. Across the board, depth is more of a concern this year, but there's room for young players such as defensive end Danny Okoye or cornerback Jacobe Johnson to step forward.

Under head coach Brent Venables, defense has been the hallmark of the program, and while replicating last year's success won't be easy, the unit looks capable of continuing that trend.

SPECIALISTS Placekicker Tate Sandell is back after an All-America season in which he was 16-of-18 on field goals from 40 yards and beyond and 8-of-9 from 50 and beyond. Punter Grayson Miller also returns after averaging 45.8 yards per attempt. Sategna is a threat in the punt return game because of his elusiveness in space.

FINAL ANALYSIS Venables is in a safer situation than a year ago thanks to the playoff appearance. Building off that, the Sooners need the offense to take a step forward under Mateer's guidance and the defense to remain close to last year's levels. If those things happen, the Sooners should be positioned for another playoff run.

2025 RESULTS (10-3, 6-2 SEC)	2026 SCHEDULE	TOP 10 RECRUITS*
Aug. 30 Illinois State W 35-3	Sept. 5 UTEP	1. Bowe Bentley, QB ★★★★★
Sept. 6 Michigan W 24-13	Sept. 12 at Michigan	2. Jonathan Hatton Jr., RB ★★★★★
Sept. 13 at Temple W 42-3	Sept. 19 New Mexico	3. Tyler Ruxer, TE ★★★★★
Sept. 20 Auburn W 24-17	Sept. 26 at Georgia	4. Jake Kreul, EDGE ★★★★★
Oct. 4 Kent State W 44-0	Oct. 10 vs. Texas #	5. Deacon Schmitt, IOL ★★★★★
Oct. 11 vs. Texas # L 6-23	Oct. 17 Kentucky	6. Jahsieur Rogers, WR ★★★★★
Oct. 18 at South Carolina W 26-7	Oct. 24 at Mississippi State	7. Jacob Curry, LB ★★★★★
Oct. 25 Ole Miss L 26-34	Oct. 31 South Carolina	8. Derrick Johnson II, CB ★★★★★
Nov. 1 at Tennessee W 33-27	Nov. 7 at Florida	9. Daniel Norman, EDGE ★★★★★
Nov. 15 at Alabama W 23-21	Nov. 14 Ole Miss	10. Matthew Nelson, EDGE ★★★★★
Nov. 22 Missouri W 17-6	Nov. 21 Texas A&M	
Nov. 29 LSU W 17-13	Nov. 28 at Missouri	
Dec. 19 Alabama % L 24-34	#Dallas	*Per Rivals
#Dallas %CFB Playoff First Round		
TEAM INFORMATION		
Head Coach: Brent Venables • Record at School: 32-20 (4 years)		
Career Record: 32-20 (4 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Ben Arbuckle		
Defensive Coordinator: Brent Venables • Location: Norman, Okla.		
Stadium: Gaylord Family Oklahoma Memorial Stadium (80,126)		



OLE MISS REBELS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 11 | SEC PREDICTION: 6 | 2025 RECORD: 13-2, 7-1 SEC

OFFENSE After fighting the NCAA for eligibility this offseason, quarterback Trinidad Chambliss returns to play quarterback for Ole Miss in 2026. Chambliss went from backup to superstar last season, finishing eighth in Heisman Trophy voting and leading the Rebels to their first College Football Playoff berth. He was 10th nationally with 297.6 yards of total offense per game. He will be flanked by one of the nation's best running backs, Doak Walker Award finalist Kewan Lacy, who ran for 1,567 yards and 24 touchdowns.

The Rebels must replace more than 3,000 yards in receiving production and both starting tackles.

DEFENSE While losing leading edge rusher Princewill Umanmielen to LSU was a tough pill to swallow, Ole Miss returns a formidable defensive front headlined by a pair of homegrown talents entering their junior seasons. Tackle Will Echoles — the Sugar Bowl defensive MVP — finished with 11.5 tackles for a loss and five sacks, while end Kam Franklin had nine tackles for loss and five sacks.

Versatile linebacker Suntarine Perkins returns as well; he has 179 tackles, 32 tackles for a loss and 18.5 sacks in his career. Defensive backs Antonio Kite and Jaylon Braxton figure to headline a revamped secondary that includes highly touted transfers Edwin Joseph (Florida State) and Jalyn Crawford (Auburn).

SPECIALISTS Placekicker Lucas Carneiro is one of the top kickers in the nation; he made two 50-plus-yard kicks and the game-winning 47-yarder in the Sugar Bowl alone, and he hit 31-of-35 field goals overall. Punter Oscar Bird averaged 46 yards per punt and pinned 14 punts inside the 20-yard line as a freshman.

FINAL ANALYSIS Ole Miss got a taste of life after Lane Kiffin in the CFP, and the Rebel faithful have to like what they've seen so far in head coach Pete Golding, the team's former defensive coordinator. Ole Miss blew out Tulane in its CFP opener before winning an epic comeback over Georgia in the Sugar Bowl. The Rebels came up just short of an appearance in the national title game, falling to Miami (Fla.) 31-27 in the Fiesta Bowl.

A No. 3 finish in the AP Poll and the return of Chambliss and Lacy, among others, have set sky-high expectations in Oxford. The schedule is loaded, even by SEC standards. Ole Miss' SEC opener on Sept. 19 against Kiffin and LSU at Vaught-Hemingway Stadium will be appointment television and could set the tone for what might be another special season for the Rebels.

2025 RESULTS (13-2, 7-1 SEC)			2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 30	Georgia State	W 63-7	Sept. 6	vs. Louisville #	1. Jase Mathews, WR	★★★★
Sept. 6	at Kentucky	W 30-23	Sept. 12	Charlotte	2. Landon Barnes, EDGE	★★★★
Sept. 13	Arkansas	W 41-35	Sept. 19	LSU	3. Damarious Yates, RB	★★★★
Sept. 20	Tulane	W 45-10	Sept. 26	at Florida	4. Craig Tutt, S	★★★★
Sept. 27	LSU	W 24-19	Oct. 10	at Vanderbilt	5. Emanuel Faulkner, OT	★★★★
Oct. 11	Washington State	W 24-21	Oct. 17	Missouri	6. Jayden Curtis, DL	★★★★
Oct. 18	at Georgia	L 35-43	Oct. 24	at Texas	7. Iverson McCoy, CB	★★★
Oct. 25	at Oklahoma	W 34-26	Oct. 31	Auburn	8. Dorian Barney, CB	★★★
Nov. 1	South Carolina	W 30-14	Nov. 7	Georgia	9. Carmel Reed, DL	★★★
Nov. 8	The Citadel	W 49-0	Nov. 14	at Oklahoma	10. Ant Davis, LB	★★★
Nov. 15	Florida	W 34-24	Nov. 21	Wofford		
Nov. 28	at Mississippi State	W 38-19	Nov. 28	Mississippi State		
Dec. 20	Tulane #	W 41-10		#Nashville, TN		*Per Rivals
Jan. 1	vs. Georgia %	W 39-34	TEAM INFORMATION			
Jan. 8	vs. Miami (Fla.) &	L 27-31	Head Coach: Pete Golding • Record at School: 2-1 (1 year)			
#CFB Playoff First Round %Sugar Bowl: CFB Playoff Quarterfinal & Fiesta Bowl: CFB Playoff Semifinal			Career Record: 2-1 (1 year) • Offensive Coordinators: John David Baker, Cody Woodiel • Defensive Coordinators: Bryan Brown, Marcus Woodson			
			Location: Oxford, Miss. • Stadium: Vaught-Hemingway Stadium (64,038)			



TRINIDAD CHAMBLISS

SCOUTING THE REBELS

"In those three games that he coached last year, Pete Golding was Pete Golding. He was himself. He naturally transitioned into his role while staying the same dude. That's gonna be the challenge. Can he continue to rely on all the things that have made him a big-time ball coach, or is he going to try to be the anti-Lane [Kiffin]? A lot of people in Oxford want him to be the anti-Lane, but he just needs to be Pete Golding. ... [Trinidad Chambliss] is absolutely the top returning quarterback in the country. He's a winner, he's got a feel for the game, he's got presence, he looks like he's got tremendous leadership skills. But can that defense be improved enough to let the growth happen offensively without [former offensive coordinator] Charlie Weis Jr.?"

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (5)

WR	15	Darrell Gill Jr.* (Sr.)	0	Johntay Cook II* (Sr.)
WR	3	Caleb Cunningham (Fr.)	11	Horatio Fields* (Sr.)
WR	1	Deuce Alexander (Jr.)	7	Traylon Ray (Jr.)
LT	61	Tommy Kinsler IV* (Jr.)	77	Enoch Wangoy* (So.)
LG	51	DELANO TOWNSEND (JR.)	50	Troy Everett* (Sr.)
C	62	BRYCEN SANDERS (JR.)	65	Connor Howes (So.)
RG	75	PATRICK KUTAS (SR.)	76	John Wayne Oliver (So.)
RT	57	Carius Curne* (So.)	55	Terez Davis (So.)
TE	9	Luke Hasz (Sr.)	4	Caleb Odom (Jr.)
QB	6	TRINIDAD CHAMBLISS (SR.)	2	Deuce Knight* (Fr.)
RB	5	KEWAN LACY (JR.)	25	Makhi Frazier* (Jr.)

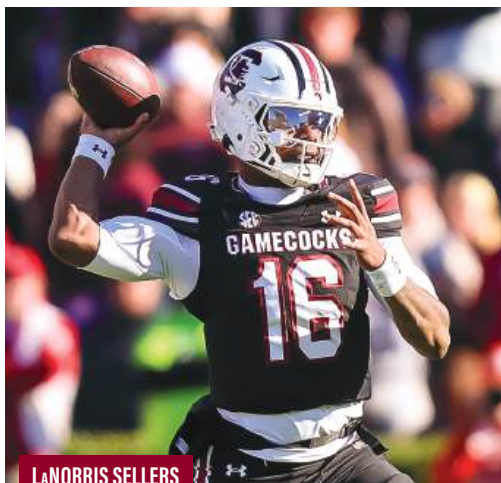
DEFENSE (5)

DE	5	KAM FRANKLIN (JR.)	15	Landon Barnes (Fr.)
DT	52	WILL ECHOLES (JR.)	9	Jehiem Oatis* (Sr.)
DT	88	Michai Boireau* (Jr.)	96	Jamarious Brown (Jr.)
EDGE	1	Jordan Renaud* (Jr.)	3	Blake Purchase* (Jr.)
LB	4	SUNTARINE PERKINS (SR.)	26	Ant Davis (Fr.)
LB	12	Luke Ferrelli* (So.)	49	Tah'j Butler* (Jr.)
LB	11	Keaton Thomas* (Sr.)	23	Jacoby Hopson (Fr.)
CB	8	ANTONIO KITE (SR.)	28	Dante Core (Fr.)
CB	2	JAYLON BRAXTON (JR.)	0	Jalyn Crawford* (Jr.)
S	7	Sharif Denson* (Sr.)	6	Joel Aguerro* (Sr.)
S	14	Edwin Joseph* (Jr.)	31	Ladarian Clardy (So.)

SPECIALISTS

K	17	Lucas Carneiro (Sr.)	KR	7	Traylon Ray (Jr.)
P	33	Oscar Bird (So.)	PR	7	Traylon Ray (Jr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



LANORRIS SELLERS

SCOUTING THE GAMECOCKS

"I don't know that they're gonna be better. I haven't felt very good about them the last couple of years, other than that they have an elite edge rusher. But they've already got a couple of tackles hurt, which could factor into it. My guess is they'll be decent, middle of the pack. ... [QB LaNorris Sellers] is an elite athlete. He's very hot and cold. If they can protect him but allow him to show his athleticism, they can be a legitimate problem. He's one of the strongest people I've ever seen live. He's a mismatch for almost everybody. If he feels overwhelmed like he did last year, that wouldn't be good. But I think they're gonna make it easy and get the ball out of his hands, as well as some designed runs where he's taking on a DB in space or out-athleting D-linemen."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (4)

WR	8	NYCK HARBOR (SR.)	7	Jordon Gidron (Fr.)
WR	17	JAYDEN SELLERS (SO.)	3	Mazeo Bennett Jr. (Jr.)
WR	1	Nitro Tuggle* (Jr.)	6	Donovan Murph (So.)
LT	72	SHED SARRATT JR. (SO.)	55	Adedamola Ajidahun (Fr.)
LG	52	Hank Purvis* (Jr.)	71	Blake Franks (So.)
C	50	Carter Miller* (Sr.)	62	Nolan Hay (Sr.)
RG	69	Emmanuel Kojo Poku* (Sr.)	58	Markee Anderson (Jr.)
RT	75	Dayne Arnett* (Sr.)	76	Zyon Guiles (Fr.)
TE	87	Brady Hunt (Sr.)	5	Mike Tyler (So.)
QB	16	LANORRIS SELLERS (JR.)	12	Cutter Woods (Fr.)
RB	28	Matt Fuller (So.)	10	Christian Clark* (So.)

DEFENSE (5)

EDGE	6	DYLAN STEWART (JR.)	10	George Wilson Jr. (Sr.)
DT	99	Gabriel Brownlow-Dindy (Sr.)	33	Troy Pikes (Jr.)
DT	13	Tomiwa Durojaiye* (Sr.)	97	Kelby Collins* (Sr.)
EDGE	93	Julian Walker (Fr.)	39	Caleb Herring* (Sr.)
LB	0	JAYR JOHNSON (JR.)	7	Shawn Murphy (Sr.)
LB	17	JUSTIN OKORONKWO (JR.)	15	Donovan Darden (So.)
CB	8	JUDGE COLLIER (SR.)	19	Damarcus Leach (So.)
CB	4	Vicari Swain (Jr.)	42	Jalewis Solomon (So.)
NB	12	Quay'sheed Scott* (Jr.)	1	Gerald Kilgore (Sr.)
S	31	PEYTON WILLIAMS (SR.)	5	Kendall Daniels Jr. (So.)
S	9	David Bucey (Jr.)	14	J'Zavien Currence (Fr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	14	Max Kelley (So.)	KR	8	Nyck Harbor (Sr.)
P	24	Mason Love (So.)	PR	4	Vicari Swain (Jr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • * 2026 TRANSFERS



SOUTH CAROLINA GAMECOCKS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 28 | SEC PREDICTION: 10 | 2025 RECORD: 4-8, 1-7 SEC

OFFENSE LaNorris Sellers is back for another go-round, hoping to make up for what was a disappointing second season under center. He'll have new coordinator Kendal Briles and a rebuilt running back room to help, but the offensive line is a major concern, especially with tackle Josiah Thompson out for the year and transfer tackle Jacarius Peak questionable at best to play any games this year due to a lingering knee injury.

As he proved last year, Sellers can't operate without line support (43 sacks allowed, 15th in the SEC) and with a playbook that forced him to limit his running and hold onto the ball until his receivers could get loose. The Gamecocks offense ranked 15th in the SEC in scoring and 14th in rushing, and former coordinator Mike Shula was fired at midseason.

The assumption is that Briles will try to overcome the line's weaknesses with Sellers' mobility and that he will maximize what the Gamecocks do have — depth and talent at receiver and tight end. Nyck Harbor, Nitro Tuggle, Donovan Murph, Mazeo Bennett Jr., Brady Hunt, Mike Tyler and Sellers' brother Jayden should all have a turn catching the ball.

DEFENSE In 2024, the South Carolina defense was one of the best in the SEC. A year later, deprived of playmaking draft picks and having to be on the field too much due to a misfiring offense, it ranked 10th. Worse, it lost two draft picks and a four-year starter in DQ Smith. With Dylan Stewart sitting out of spring ball recovering from a back injury, the early part of the season for coordinator Clayton White's unit will be crucial.

USC has to be stronger up front and brought in several transfers to aid that effort. Stewart's back issues, and the fact that he was double-teamed on almost every snap, limited him to 12 tackles for a loss and 4.5 sacks last year. He can team with heralded prospect Julian Walker at the other edge spot to create a fearsome pass rush.

Judge Collier and Peyton Williams (two interceptions in 2025) lead the secondary, with true freshman J'Zavien Currence coming on.

SPECIALISTS Mason Love returns after finishing fourth in the SEC in punting last year (45.1-yard average), but South Carolina needs a new placekicker. Vicari Swain returned three punts for touchdowns in 2025.

FINAL ANALYSIS USC cratered under head coach Shane Beamer last year, going 4-8 a year removed from a 9-4 season. The Gamecocks return Sellers but have a new offensive coordinator and a beat-up O-line. Their defense was good but not great and lost some talent.

Expectations were high last year and went unmet. USC is a program that has struggled to sustain success when reality says a winning season should be the norm. A winning season should be the ceiling this year.

2025 RESULTS (4-8, 1-7 SEC)

Aug. 31	vs. Virginia Tech #	W	24-11
Sept. 6	South Carolina State	W	38-10
Sept. 13	Vanderbilt	L	7-31
Sept. 20	at Missouri	L	20-29
Sept. 27	Kentucky	W	35-13
Oct. 11	at LSU	L	10-20
Oct. 18	Oklahoma	L	7-26
Oct. 25	Alabama	L	22-29
Nov. 1	at Ole Miss	L	14-30
Nov. 15	at Texas A&M	L	30-31
Nov. 22	Coastal Carolina	W	51-7
Nov. 29	Clemson	L	14-28

#Atlanta

2026 SCHEDULE

Sept. 5	Kent State
Sept. 12	Towson
Sept. 19	Mississippi State
Sept. 26	at Alabama
Oct. 3	Kentucky
Oct. 10	at Florida
Oct. 24	Tennessee
Oct. 31	at Oklahoma
Nov. 7	Texas A&M
Nov. 14	at Arkansas
Nov. 21	Georgia
Nov. 28	at Clemson

TOP 10 RECRUITS*

1.	Julian Walker, EDGE	★★★★★
2.	Zyon Guiles, IOL	★★★★
3.	J'Zavien Currence, S	★★★★
4.	Darius Gray, IOL	★★★★
5.	Aiden Harris, DL	★★★★
6.	Landon Duckworth, QB	★★★★
7.	Kosci Barnes, CB	★★★★
8.	Caden Ramsey, TE	★★★★
9.	Andrew Harris, EDGE	★★★
10.	KJ Johnson, CB	★★★

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Shane Beamer • Record at School: 33-30 (5 years)
Career Record: 33-30 (5 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Kendal Briles
Defensive Coordinators: Clayton White, Torrian Gray • Location: Columbia, S.C.
Stadium: Williams-Brice Stadium (77,559)



TENNESSEE VOLUNTEERS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 21 | SEC PREDICTION: 8 | 2025 RECORD: 8-5, 4-4 SEC

OFFENSE The 2026 season is a critical one for head coach Josh Heupel, and adding to the stress, he's breaking in a new quarterback. Joey Aguilar keyed Tennessee's offensive resurgence in 2025, but he is out of eligibility. George MacIntyre might have the edge because he's been in Heupel's system for a year. Colorado transfer Ryan Staub (427 passing yards, three TDs, four INTs last season) has the most experience, and 5-star freshman Faizon Brandon, a top-10 recruit nationally, has the highest ceiling.

Leading wide receiver Chris Brazzell II is off to the NFL after an impressive campaign, but Braylon Staley's return bolsters an otherwise young receiving corps.

Running back DeSean Bishop returns after rushing for 1,076 yards during an All-SEC campaign, and he'll help ease the new quarterback's transition. Tulane transfer Javin Gordon and Daune Morris comprise the rest of the backfield. They'll play behind an offensive line that returns five starters and a number of contributors.

DEFENSE The defense was the Vols' biggest liability last season. Heupel fired coordinator Tim Banks after five seasons and brought in ex-Penn State DC Jim Knowles as his replacement.

Chaz Coleman followed Knowles from State College and could be the next standout edge on the defensive front. Tackle Daevin Hobbs brings experience, but he missed much of the spring with a foot injury.

Amare Campbell is another addition from Penn State, and persuading Arion Carter to return was huge for the linebacking corps. Edwin Spillman and Jadon Perlotte are back after solid freshman seasons.

Injuries plagued the cornerbacks last season. Ty Redmond took advantage of his opportunities and was third-team All-SEC as a freshman. Transfers TJ Metcalf (Michigan) and DJ Burks (Appalachian State) bring experience to the safety spots alongside returning starter Edrees Farooq.

SPECIALISTS Cooper Ranvier, an All-ACC kicker at Louisville, replaces Max Gilbert, who transferred after starting the past two seasons. Punter Jackson Ross returns for his fourth season after averaging 44.0 yards per punt as a junior. Joakim Dodson, who returned a kickoff for a touchdown vs. Illinois in the Music City Bowl, could provide a threat on returns.

FINAL ANALYSIS The offense carried the Vols last season, but defensive struggles led to a disappointing 8-5 finish. Heupel took a big step toward fixing those issues by hiring Knowles and adding impact transfers familiar with his system. Too many questions remain at quarterback to know if the offense can approach what it did last season. Couple that with a challenging schedule, and there will be very little room for error.

2025 RESULTS (8-5, 4-4 SEC)	2026 SCHEDULE	TOP 10 RECRUITS*
Aug. 30 vs. Syracuse # W 45-26	Sept. 5 Furman	1. Tristen Keys, WR ★★★★★
Sept. 6 ETSU W 72-17	Sept. 12 at Georgia Tech	2. Faizon Brandon, QB ★★★★★
Sept. 13 Georgia (ot) L 41-44	Sept. 19 Kennesaw State	3. Carter Gooden, EDGE ★★★★★
Sept. 20 UAB W 56-24	Sept. 26 Texas	4. Braydyn Rouse, LB ★★★★★
Sept. 27 at Mississippi St. (ot) W 41-34	Oct. 3 Auburn	5. Zaydyn Anderson, CB ★★★★★
Oct. 11 Arkansas W 34-31	Oct. 10 at Arkansas	6. Joel Wyatt, S ★★★★★
Oct. 18 at Alabama L 20-37	Oct. 17 Alabama	7. Tyreek King, WR ★★★★★
Oct. 25 at Kentucky W 56-34	Oct. 24 at South Carolina	8. TJ White, LB ★★★★★
Nov. 1 Oklahoma L 27-33	Nov. 7 Kentucky	9. Kamari Blair, OT ★★★★★
Nov. 15 New Mexico State W 42-9	Nov. 14 at Texas A&M	10. Gabriel Osenda, OT ★★★★★
Nov. 22 at Florida W 31-11	Nov. 21 LSU	
Nov. 29 Vanderbilt L 24-45	Nov. 28 at Vanderbilt	<i>*Per Rivals</i>
Dec. 30 vs. Illinois % L 28-30		
#Atlanta %Music City Bowl		
TEAM INFORMATION		
Head Coach: Josh Heupel • Record at School: 45-20 (5 years)		
Career Record: 73-28 (8 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Joey Halzle		
Defensive Coordinators: Jim Knowles, Anthony Poindexter		
Location: Knoxville, Tenn. • Stadium: Neyland Stadium (101,915)		



DeSEAN BISHOP

SCOUTING THE VOLUNTEERS

"Having the [Joey] Aguilar deal not go their way is a good thing for the SEC. They're unproven at quarterback. It's a pivotal year for them to succeed. I don't think they'll be better. Without a veteran quarterback in that system, you don't feel the same energy and excitement around that program. Every time we've faced them or versions of them, it all runs through their quarterback and how confident he is at stretching the field and how mobile he is. ... They want to run the ball. But do they have enough of a threat downfield to open up the run lanes? The last time they were extremely potent was when [former offensive coordinator Alex] Golesh was there."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (8)

WR	4	MIKE MATTHEWS (JR.)	1	Travis Smith Jr. (So.)
WR	14	BRAYLON STALEY (SO.)	81	Ian Duarte* (Jr.)
WR	5	Radarius Jackson (So.)	80	TK Keys (Fr.)
LT	70	DAVID SANDERS JR. (SO.)	51	Jeremias Heard (So.)
LG	75	WENDELL MOE JR. (SR.)	74	SHAMURAD UMAROV (JR.)
C	56	SAM PENDLETON (JR.)	58	Nic Moore (Fr.)
RG	72	JESSE PERRY (SO.)	67	Donovan Haslam* (Sr.)
RT	77	Ory Williams (So.)	79	Gabriel Osenda (Fr.)
TE	0	Ethan Davis (Jr.)	7	DaSaahn Brame (So.)
QB	15	George MacIntyre (Fr.)	17	Ryan Staub* (Jr.)
RB	18	DESEAN BISHOP (JR.)	21	Javin Gordon* (So.)

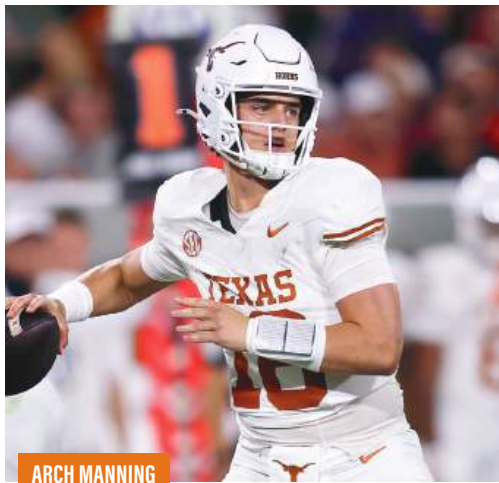
DEFENSE (4)

DE	18	Tyree Weathersby (Jr.)	9	Mariyon Dye (So.)
DT	5	Daevin Hobbs (Sr.)	17	Ethan Utley (So.)
DT	54	Xavier Gilliam* (So.)	94	Nathan Robinson (Jr.)
EDGE	90	Chaz Coleman* (So.)	93	Jordan Norman* (Jr.)
MLB	55	Amare Campbell* (Sr.)	22	JEREMIAH TELANDER (SR.)
WLB	7	ARION CARTER (SR.)	13	Edwin Spillman (So.)
CB	4	TY REDMOND (SO.)	21	Tre Poteat III (So.)
CB	20	Kayin Lee* (Sr.)	29	Jadai Richard* (Sr.)
NB	19	Qua Moss* (Sr.)	37	Isaiah Hardge* (Jr.)
SS	15	EDREES FAROOQ (JR.)	26	Sidney Walton (So.)
FS	28	TJ Metcalf* (Sr.)	42	DJ Burks* (Sr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	97	Cooper Ranvier* (So.)	KR	89	Joakim Dodson (Fr.)
P	98	Jackson Ross (Sr.)	PR	89	Joakim Dodson (Fr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



ARCH MANNING

SCOUTING THE LONGHORNS

"They made some bold moves. Obviously, there's a ton of money in that program, so you've gotta feel like they made moves that they felt they had to make to make their program better. What's that gonna look like after a loss or two? I don't know. ... I thought Arch [Manning] got better as the season went on. Is he what he was unfairly hyped to be? Probably not, but I think he's a good solid quarterback in this league. On paper, I think they're the team to beat in the SEC. They might be preseason No. 1 again. ... [Manning] is gonna be just fine. I think he did such a good job of managing it, but he was put in a tough situation. It was literally a 'Heisman or bust' situation for a kid who hadn't played yet. But he's super talented, he does everything right, he prepares hard, he'll be just fine."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (6)

WR	8	Cam Coleman* (Jr.)	18	Sterling Berkhalter* (Sr.)
WR	1	RYAN WINGO (JR.)	7	Kaliq Lockett (Fr.)
WR	3	EMMETT MOSLEY V (JR.)	4	Jermaine Bishop Jr. (Fr.)
LT	74	TREVOR GOOSBY (JR.)	78	Jordan Coleman (Fr.)
LG	50	Laurence Seymour* (Sr.)	75	Jaydon Chatman (Jr.)
C	62	CONNOR ROBERTSON (SR.)	56	Dylan Sikorski* (So.)
RG	73	BRANDON BAKER (JR.)	58	Devin Coleman (Fr.)
RT	71	Melvin Siani* (Sr.)	77	Andre Cojoe (So.)
TE	15	Michael Masunas* (Jr.)	83	Spencer Shannon (Jr.)
QB	16	ARCH MANNING (JR.)	9	Karle "KJ" Lacey Jr. (Fr.)
RB	0	Raleek Brown* (Sr.)	2	Hollywood Smothers* (Jr.)

DEFENSE (5)

DE	40	Lance Jackson (So.)	19	Zina Umeozulu (So.)
DT	93	HERO KANU (SR.)	95	Ian Geffrard* (Sr.)
DT	97	ALEX JANUARY (JR.)	88	Maraad Watson (Jr.)
OLB	1	COLIN SIMMONS (JR.)	14	Brad Spence (Sr.)
ILB	3	Rasheem Biles* (Sr.)	16	Tyler Atkinson (Fr.)
ILB	26	Ty'Anthony Smith (Jr.)	28	Justin Cryer* (Sr.)
CB	5	Bo Mascoc* (Sr.)	6	Kobe Black (Jr.)
CB	8	Kade Phillips (So.)	24	Warren Roberson (Jr.)
STAR	29	GRACESON LITTLETON (SO.)	27	Wardell Mack (So.)
S	4	JELANI MCDONALD (SR.)	9	Jonah Williams (So.)
S	17	Xavier Filsaime (Jr.)	2	Derek Williams Jr. (Jr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	44	Gianni Spetic* (Sr.)	KR	0	Raleek Brown* (Sr.)
P	43	Mac Chiumento* (Sr.)	PR	21	Ryan Niblett (Jr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



TEXAS LONGHORNS

NATIONAL FORECAST: 3 | SEC PREDICTION: 2 | 2025 RECORD: 10-3, 6-2 SEC

OFFENSE After watching quarterback Arch Manning finish the 2025 season by throwing for 11 touchdowns with one interception over the final five games while running for four TDs and even catching a TD pass, head coach Steve Sarkisian went all-in to try to win a national championship by creating the most explosive offense possible. In came the transfers — big-play wide receiver Cam Coleman (Auburn), electric running backs Raleek Brown (Arizona State) and Hollywood Smothers (NC State) and tackle Melvin Siani (Wake Forest). Texas also added 5-star wideout Jermaine Bishop Jr., who is drawing comparisons to a young Xavier Worthy. "Our ability to create explosive plays is showing up," Sarkisian said coming out of spring ball.

Texas needs to hit on its O-line transfers because the inconsistency of last year's offensive line was a major contributor to the Longhorns averaging the fewest points per game (30.5) of the Sarkisian era in Austin.

DEFENSE Sarkisian traded out a top-notch defensive coordinator in Pete Kwiatkowski (whose defenses gave up an average of 18.1 ppg the last three seasons) in hopes of an even better one with the hire of Will Muschamp, who spent four of the past five years on Kirby Smart's staff at Georgia, brought Smart's double-A-gap pressure with him back to Texas, where Muschamp served as DC from 2008-10.

Muschamp has playmakers at every level with end Colin Simmons, the SEC's sack leader (12) in 2025; linebacker Ty'Anthony Smith and transfers Rasheem Biles (Pitt) and Justin Cryer (Florida State); and safety Jelani McDonald (team leader in tackles and interceptions in 2025).

Gone is Kwiatkowski's bend-but-don't-break philosophy in favor of Muschamp's attacking style, which includes cornerbacks playing press-man instead of off coverage.

SPECIALISTS Texas will have a new placekicker, punter and long-snapper in 2026 — Gianni Spetic (Memphis), Mac Chiumento (Florida State) and Trey Dubuc (New Mexico), respectively. Junior Ryan Niblett finished as the nation's No. 2 punt returner in 2025 with punts returned for TDs in wins over Oklahoma and Mississippi State.

FINAL ANALYSIS With a confident Manning leading the team, the Longhorns should be better equipped to face Ohio State in Austin. Texas needs its top transfers — Coleman, Biles, Brown, Smothers, Siani and CB Bo Mascoc (Rutgers) — to come through and stay healthy. If that happens, the Longhorns have a chance to make a deep playoff run in what is likely to be the final season for juniors Manning, Coleman and Simmons.

2025 RESULTS (10-3, 6-2 SEC)

Aug. 30	at Ohio State	L	7-14
Sept. 6	San José State	W	38-7
Sept. 13	UTEP	W	27-10
Sept. 20	Sam Houston	W	55-0
Oct. 4	at Florida	L	21-29
Oct. 11	vs. Oklahoma #	W	23-6
Oct. 18	at Kentucky (ot)	W	16-13
Oct. 25	at Mississippi St. (ot)	W	45-38
Nov. 1	Vanderbilt	W	34-31
Nov. 15	at Georgia	L	10-35
Nov. 22	Arkansas	W	52-37
Nov. 28	Texas A&M	W	27-17
Dec. 31	vs. Michigan %	W	41-27

#Dallas %Citrus Bowl

2026 SCHEDULE

Sept. 5	Texas State
Sept. 12	Ohio State
Sept. 19	UTSA
Sept. 26	at Tennessee
Oct. 10	vs. Oklahoma #
Oct. 17	Florida
Oct. 24	Ole Miss
Oct. 31	Mississippi State
Nov. 7	at Missouri
Nov. 14	at LSU
Nov. 21	Arkansas
Nov. 27	at Texas A&M

#Dallas

TOP 10 RECRUITS*

1. Richard Wesley, EDGE	★★★★★
2. Dia Bell, QB	★★★★★
3. Jamarion Carlton, DL	★★★★
4. Tyler Atkinson, LB	★★★★
5. John Turntine III, IOL	★★★★
6. James Johnson, DL	★★★★
7. Kosi Okpala, EDGE	★★★★
8. Jermaine Bishop Jr., ATH	★★★★
9. Nicolas Robertson, IOL	★★★★
10. Kohen Brown, WR	★★★★

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Steve Sarkisian • Record at School: 48-20 (5 years)
Career Record: 93-55 (11+ years) • Offensive Coordinator: Kyle Flood
Defensive Coordinators: Will Muschamp, Johnny Nansen • Location: Austin, Texas • Stadium: Darrell K Royal-Texas Memorial Stadium (100,119)



TEXAS A&M AGGIES

NATIONAL FORECAST: 9 | SEC PREDICTION: 4 | 2025 RECORD: 11-2, 7-1 SEC

OFFENSE The Aggies have no shortage of big-play ability. They need consistency, though, and that starts with junior quarterback Marcel Reed. Last season, Reed passed for 3,169 yards and 25 touchdowns. He rushed for another 493 yards and six TDs. But he threw a dozen interceptions and struggled in season-closing losses to Texas and Miami (Fla.). New offensive coordinator Holmon Wiggins and quarterbacks coach Joey Lynch are tasked with helping Reed boost production and stability.

The return of leading rusher Rueben Owens II will help. So will All-SEC receiver Mario Craver, who had 917 receiving yards in 2025. Craver is joined by Ashton Bethel-Roman, who also emerged in the second half of last season, and Alabama transfer Isaiah Horton. The 6-foot-4 Horton fills a need for a big receiver who can win on 50-50 balls.

Center Mark Nabou Jr. is the only returning starter on the offensive line. However, A&M restocked the line with four transfers with SEC starting experience. The most notable additions are tackles Wilkin Formby from Alabama and Tyree Adams from LSU.

DEFENSE The secondary projects as the strength of the defense. Safeties Marcus Ratcliffe and Dalton Brooks and cornerback Dezz Ricks are proven. The Aggies were third in the SEC in passing defense last season. That's the good news. The bad news is that they managed only three interceptions, a total that must rise.

A&M was fourth in the nation in sacks last season, but SEC Defensive Player of the Year Cashius Howell is gone. Fingers are crossed that sophomore Marco Jones or transfer Anto Saka can step into Howell's role and lead another fierce pass rush.

Linebacker Ray Coney, a transfer from Tulsa, was 10th in the nation in tackles. Perhaps he can help end the Aggies' frustrating tendency to give up long runs.

SPECIALISTS Illinois transfer David Olano should remedy an erratic kicking game. His career field goal success rate is 86%, which would be a massive upgrade. A&M has a history of explosive return specialists. Craver (punts) and fellow wideout Terry Bussey (kickoffs) can continue that trend.

FINAL ANALYSIS More than 30 years have passed since A&M had consecutive 10-win seasons. Ending the drought likely requires an improved Reed and an effective offensive line. Head coach Mike Elko appears confident. "I think we have a unique opportunity to double down on success," he says. "We have found ways, at times over the years, to hit one-year peaks. The next step for us is consistently being a top-10 team, consistently being a playoff team, consistently being a team that finishes and gets to Atlanta."

2025 RESULTS (11-2, 7-1 SEC)				2026 SCHEDULE		TOP 10 RECRUITS*	
Aug. 30	UTSA	W	42-24	Sept. 5	Missouri State	1. Brandon Arrington, CB	★★★★★
Sept. 6	Utah State	W	44-22	Sept. 12	Arizona State	2. KJ Edwards, RB	★★★★
Sept. 13	at Notre Dame	W	41-40	Sept. 19	Kentucky	3. Sam Roseborough, IOL	★★★★
Sept. 27	Auburn	W	16-10	Sept. 26	at LSU	4. Bryce Perry-Wright, EDGE	★★★★
Oct. 4	Mississippi State	W	31-9	Oct. 3	Arkansas	5. Jayden Warren, WR	★★★★
Oct. 11	Florida	W	34-17	Oct. 10	at Missouri	6. Aaron Gregory, WR	★★★★
Oct. 18	at Arkansas	W	45-42	Oct. 17	The Citadel	7. Tylan Wilson, S	★★★★
Oct. 25	at LSU	W	49-25	Oct. 24	at Alabama	8. KK Johnson, ATH	★★★★
Nov. 8	at Missouri	W	38-17	Nov. 7	at South Carolina	9. Chance Collins, S	★★★★
Nov. 15	South Carolina	W	31-30	Nov. 14	Tennessee	10. Vic Singleton, CB	★★★★
Nov. 22	Samford	W	48-0	Nov. 21	at Oklahoma		*Per Rivals
Nov. 28	at Texas	L	17-27	Nov. 27	Texas		
Dec. 20	Miami (Fla.)#	L	3-10				
#CFB Playoff First Round				TEAM INFORMATION Head Coach: Mike Elko • Record at School: 19-7 (2 years) Career Record: 35-16 (4 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Holmon Wiggins Defensive Coordinators: Lyle Hemphill, Elijah Robinson • Location: College Station, Texas • Stadium: Kyle Field (102,733)			



MARCEL REED

SCOUTING THE AGGIES

"I always thought [QB Marcel Reed] was a great athlete. Respect him, but I always judge those guys on, 'Do they win those big games? Are they the main difference?' He's got a year under his belt, but there's gonna be more pressure on him facing the top half of the league and not have it just come down to the Texas game at the end. ... Mike Elko is a real-deal ball coach. The way they carry themselves, the way they compete, how physical they are on both sides of the line of scrimmage. They play complete team football. You watch them and you see the way they handle adversity at times throughout the season — that doesn't just happen unless you've got a culture."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (4)

WR	1	MARIO CRAVER (JR.)	6	Terry Bussey (Jr.)
WR	8	ASHTON BETHEL-ROMAN (SO.)	18	TK Norman (Fr.)
WR	7	Isaiah Horton* (Sr.)	3	Aaron Gregory (Fr.)
LT	71	Tyree Adams* (Jr.)	70	Robert Bourdon (So.)
LG	78	Coen Echols* (So.)	77	Tyler Thomas (Fr.)
C	54	MARK NABOU JR. (SR.)	73	Ashton Funk (So.)
RG	76	Trovon Baugh* (Sr.)	52	Blake Ivy (So.)
RT	75	Wilkin Formby* (Sr.)	79	Lamont Rogers (Fr.)
TE	84	Richie Anderson* (Jr.)	87	Houston Thomas* (Sr.)
QB	10	MARCEL REED (JR.)	13	Brady Hart (Fr.)
RB	4	Rueben Owens II (Jr.)	2	Jamarion Morrow (So.)

DEFENSE (5)

DE	10	Marco Jones (So.)	14	Anto Saka* (Sr.)
DT	5	DJ Hicks (Sr.)	11	Brandon Davis-Swain* (So.)
DT	92	CJ Mims* (Sr.)	99	Landon Rink (So.)
DE	18	T.J. SEARCY (SR.)	17	Ryan Henderson* (Sr.)
LB	21	Ray Coney* (Sr.)	54	Jordan Lockhart (Jr.)
LB	27	DAYMION SANFORD (SR.)	0	Noah Mikhail (So.)
NB	8	Jordan Shaw (Jr.)	1	Bryce Anderson (Sr.)
CB	2	DEZZ RICKS (JR.)	20	Adonyss Currie (Fr.)
CB	9	Rickey Gibson III* (Sr.)	6	Julio Humphrey (Sr.)
S	3	MARCUS RATCLIFFE (SR.)	4	Tawfiq Byard* (Jr.)
S	7	DALTON BROOKS (SR.)	13	Myles Davis (Jr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	24	David Olano* (Sr.)	KR	6	Terry Bussey (Jr.)
P	37	Tyler White (Jr.)	PR	1	Mario Craver (Jr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



SEDRICK ALEXANDER

SCOUTING THE COMMODORES

"Do I think they'll be as good without Diego [Pavia]? No. Absolutely not. Do I think they'll be competitive and in there somewhere in the middle? Yes. That time with Diego will help them recruit at a higher level, and they'll have more sustained success than they've had, but they won't be at the same level in the next year or two without Diego. I think the injection of belief and swag that [Pavia] brought to the program can carry over. They fed off it, then it became more than just him. ... [Offensive coordinator] Tim Beck does such a great job of being so fundamentally sound in what they do. There's repetitiveness of technique and play-calling, but there's multiplicity in the pre-snap looks and the pre-snap motions that makes it a complete pain."

— An opposing SEC assistant coach

DEPTH CHART

OFFENSE (4)

WR	0	JUNIOR SHERRILL (SR.)	17	Cole Adams* (Sr.)
WR	14	Ja'Cory Thomas* (Jr.)	9	Brycen Coleman (Jr.)
LT	75	Beau Johnson* (Jr.)	72	Mitchell Smith (Fr.)
LG	70	CADE MCCONNELL (SR.)	65	Micah DeBose* (So.)
C	56	Lyndon Cooper* (Sr.)	78	Keegan Wechsler (Sr.)
RG	58	Orion Irving (Sr.)	50	Gunner Givens (Sr.)
RT	51	Clinton Azubuike (Jr.)	62	CJ Williams (Jr.)
TE	16	COLE SPENCE (SR.)	45	Maurice Veney* (Jr.)
TE	18	Jayvontay Conner* (Jr.)	12	Walter Taylor* (Sr.)
QB	2	Jared Curtis (Fr.)	1	Blaze Berlowitz (Sr.)
RB	28	SEDRICK ALEXANDER (SR.)	22	Makhilyn Young (Sr.)

DEFENSE (5)

DE	10	Brian Allen Jr.* (Sr.)	17	Edwin Kolenge* (Sr.)
DT	5	Yilanan Ouattara (Sr.)	99	Talan Carter* (So.)
DT	53	GLENN SEABROOKS III (JR.)	92	Jaylon Stone (Sr.)
DE	29	MILES CAPERS (SR.)	32	Mason Carter (Jr.)
ILB	11	BRYAN LONGWELL (SR.)	20	Jamison Curtis (Jr.)
ILB	24	Nick Rinaldi (Sr.)	22	Bryce Cowan (Sr.)
CB	4	MARTEL HIGHT (SR.)	26	Cayden Daniels (So.)
CB	6	Jordan Matthews (Sr.)	2	Jaylin Lackey (Jr.)
STAR	14	Jailen Ruth (Jr.)	3	Carson Lawrence (So.)
S	8	CJ HEARD (JR.)	12	Vanzale Hinton (So.)
S	7	Ricardo Jones* (Jr.)	1	Dontae Carter (Jr.)

SPECIALISTS

K	88	Brock Taylor (Sr.)	KR	0	Junior Sherrill (Sr.)
P		Tyler Ebel* (Sr.)	PR	4	Martel Hight (Sr.)

RETURNING STARTERS IN BOLD • *2026 TRANSFER



VANDERBILT COMMODORES

NATIONAL FORECAST: 45 | SEC PREDICTION: 14 | 2025 RECORD: 10-3, 6-2 SEC

OFFENSE What does life without Diego Pavia look like for Vanderbilt? That's the big question with true freshman Jared Curtis expected to win the Commodores' starting job. Vandy pulled off an all-time stunner by flipping the 5-star recruit from his commitment to Georgia, and early buzz suggests Curtis is at least as good as advertised. But the fact remains that Curtis has zero game experience at the college level.

Only six returning SEC players racked up more receiving yards than wideout Junior Sherrill (784 yards, seven TDs) last year, and the Commodores added a couple of impact transfers: Ja'Cory Thomas from Old Dominion and Cole Adams from Alabama, the latter of whom turned heads during spring practice. Tight end should be a strength with Cole Spence returning, while East Carolina transfer Jayvontay Conner takes over for Mackey Award winner Eli Stowers in the Commodores' flex role.

An improved offensive line boosted the run game last season, but Vandy has to replace four starters. Pairing an unproven line with a freshman quarterback feels risky.

DEFENSE Vandy's defense features myriad familiar faces, with seven players who have served as full-time starters at the Power 4 level.

Pass defense has never been a strength under head coach Clark Lea, although Vandy took a step forward there last year. The rush remains a concern with projected starting edges Miles Capers and Brian Allen Jr., a transfer from Iowa, having combined for just five sacks in 2025.

A deep group of tackles and an experienced linebacker corps led by Bryan Longwell should make for a competitive run defense. The secondary, however, is where Vandy could take a big step forward with Jordan Matthews and Cayden Daniels emerging at cornerback, while Martel Hight rejoins the defense full-time after playing some wideout in 2025. Clemson transfer Ricardo Jones should improve the Commodores' back end after he tied for the ACC lead with six interceptions last fall.

SPECIALISTS Vandy's special teams have ranked among the nation's best according to metrics like SP+ over the past two years, and that should continue thanks to continuity and a solid pickup via the transfer portal in punter Tyler Ebel (FCS South Dakota). Brock Taylor is one of college football's top placekickers and has range to 60-plus yards if necessary.

FINAL ANALYSIS Despite efforts to assemble an experienced supporting cast, Vandy has questions to answer. A potentially improved defense could help ensure that Curtis isn't regularly facing huge deficits, but there are likely to be growing pains. If Curtis has a true freshman campaign similar to Trevor Lawrence's at Clemson in 2018, that would change the outlook.

2025 RESULTS (10-3, 6-2 SEC)

Aug. 30	Charleston Southern	W	45-3
Sept. 6	at Virginia Tech	W	44-20
Sept. 13	at South Carolina	W	31-7
Sept. 20	Georgia State	W	70-21
Sept. 27	Utah State	W	55-35
Oct. 4	at Alabama	L	14-30
Oct. 18	LSU	W	31-24
Oct. 25	Missouri	W	17-10
Nov. 1	at Texas	L	31-34
Nov. 8	Auburn (ot)	W	45-38
Nov. 22	Kentucky	W	45-17
Nov. 29	at Tennessee	W	45-24
Dec. 31	vs. Iowa #	L	27-34

#Reliaquest Bowl

2026 SCHEDULE

Sept. 5	Austin Peay
Sept. 12	Delaware
Sept. 19	NC State
Sept. 26	at Auburn
Oct. 3	at Georgia
Oct. 10	Ole Miss
Oct. 17	Arkansas
Oct. 24	at Kentucky
Nov. 7	at Mississippi State
Nov. 14	Alabama
Nov. 21	at Florida
Nov. 28	Tennessee

TOP 10 RECRUITS*

1.	Jared Curtis, QB	★★★★★
2.	Mitchell Smith, OT	★★★★
3.	Collin Flanigan, CB	★★★★
4.	Evan Hampton, RB	★★★★
5.	Chris Tangelo, ATH	★★★
6.	Bradley Brown, S	★★★
7.	Adam Gehm, TE	★★★
8.	Daniel Vollmer Jr., LB	★★★
9.	Jace McCallum, EDGE	★★★
10.	Owen Cabell, WR	★★★

*Per Rivals

TEAM INFORMATION

Head Coach: Clark Lea • Record at School: 26-36 (5 years) • Career Record: 26-36 (5 years) • Offensive Coordinator: Tim Beck
Defensive Coordinator: Steve Gregory • Location: Nashville, Tenn. • Stadium: FirstBank Stadium (35,000)